

saving for the j th column of I comes from its first $j - 1$ zeros. No work is required on the right side until elimination reaches row j . The forward cost is $\frac{1}{2}(n - j)^2$ instead of $\frac{1}{2}n^2$. Summing over j , the total for forward elimination on the n right sides is $\frac{1}{6}n^3$. The final multiply-subtract count for A^{-1} is n^3 if we actually want the inverse:

$$\text{For } A^{-1} \quad \frac{n^3}{3} (L \text{ and } U) + \frac{n^3}{6} (\text{forward}) + n \left(\frac{n^2}{2} \right) (\text{back substitutions}) = n^3. \quad (1)$$

Orthogonalization (A to Q): The key difference from elimination is that *each multiplier is decided by a dot product*. That takes n operations, where elimination just divides by the pivot. Then there are n “multiply-subtract” operations to remove from column k its projection along column $j < k$ (see Section 4.4). The combined cost is $2n$ where for elimination it is n . This factor 2 is the price of orthogonality. We are changing a dot product to zero where elimination changes an entry to zero.

Caution To judge a numerical algorithm, it is **not enough** to count the operations. Beyond “flop counting” is a study of stability (Householder wins) and the flow of data.

Reordering Sparse Matrices

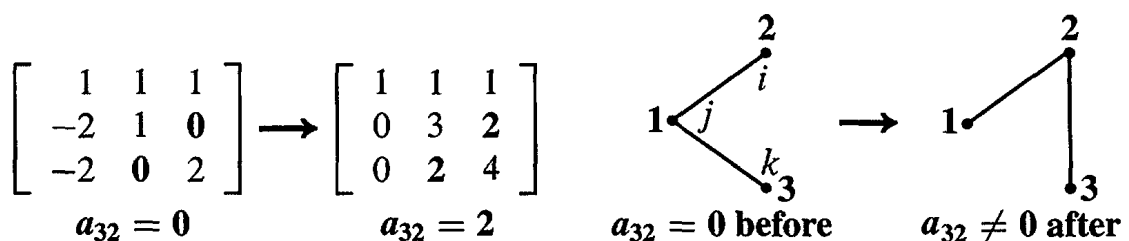
In discussing band matrices, we assumed a constant width w . The rows were in an optimal order. But for most sparse matrices in real computations, the width of the band is *not constant* and there are many zeros inside the band. Those zeros can fill in as elimination proceeds—they are lost. We need to *renumber the equations to reduce fill-in*, and thereby speed up elimination.

Generally speaking, we want to move zeros to early rows and columns. Later rows and columns are shorter anyway. The “approximate minimum degree” algorithm in sparse MATLAB is *greedy*—it chooses the row to eliminate without counting all the consequences. We may reach a nearly full matrix near the end, but the total operation count to reach LU is still much smaller. To renumber for an absolute minimum of nonzeros in L and U is an NP-hard problem, much too expensive, and **amd** is a good compromise.

We only need the *positions* of the nonzeros, not their exact values. Think of the n rows as n nodes in a graph. Node i is connected to node j if $a_{ij} \neq 0$. Watch to see how elimination can create a new edge from i to k . This means that a zero is filled in, which we are trying to avoid:

When a_{kj} is eliminated, a multiple of the pivot row $j = 1$ is subtracted from row $k = 3$.

If a_{ji} was nonzero in row j , then a_{ki} becomes nonzero in the new row k . A new edge.



In this example, the 1's change the 0's into 2's. Those entries fill in.

The graph shows each step—look at the eliminationmovie on math.mit.edu/18086. The command `nnz(L)` counts the nonzero multipliers in the lower triangular L , `find(L)` will list them, and `spy(L)` shows them all.

The matrix in the movie is the 2D version of our $-1, 2, -1$ matrix. Instead of second differences along a line, the matrix has x and y differences on a plane grid. Each point is connected to its four nearest neighbors. But it is impossible to number all the points so that neighbors stay together. If we number by rows of the grid, there is a long wait to come around to the gridpoint above.

The goal of `colamd` and `symamd` is a better ordering (permutation P) that reduces fill-in for PA and PAP^T —by choosing the pivot with the fewest nonzeros below it.

Fast Orthogonalization

There are three ways to reach the important factorization $A = QR$. Gram-Schmidt works to find the orthonormal vectors in Q . Then R is upper triangular because of the order of Gram-Schmidt steps. Now we look at better methods (Householder and Givens), which use a product of specially simple Q 's that we *know* are orthogonal.

Elimination gives $A = LU$, orthogonalization gives $A = QR$. We don't want a triangular L , we want an orthogonal Q . L is a product of E 's, with 1's on the diagonal and the multiplier ℓ_{ij} below. Q will be a product of orthogonal matrices.

There are two simple orthogonal matrices to take the place of the E 's. The *reflection matrices* $I - 2uu^T$ are named after Householder. The *plane rotation matrices* are named after Givens. The simple matrix that rotates the xy plane by θ is Q_{21} :

$$\text{Givens rotation} \quad Q_{21} = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta & 0 \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Use Q_{21} the way you used E_{21} , to produce a zero in the $(2, 1)$ position. That determines the angle θ . Bill Hager gives this example in *Applied Numerical Linear Algebra*:

$$Q_{21}A = \begin{bmatrix} .6 & .8 & 0 \\ -.8 & .6 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 90 & -153 & 114 \\ 120 & -79 & -223 \\ 200 & -40 & 395 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 150 & -155 & -110 \\ 0 & 75 & -225 \\ 200 & -40 & 395 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The zero came from $-.8(90) + .6(120)$. No need to find θ , what we needed was $\cos \theta$:

$$\cos \theta = \frac{90}{\sqrt{90^2 + 120^2}} \quad \text{and} \quad \sin \theta = \frac{-120}{\sqrt{90^2 + 120^2}}. \quad (2)$$

Now we attack the $(3, 1)$ entry. The rotation will be in rows and columns 3 and 1. The numbers $\cos \theta$ and $\sin \theta$ are determined from 150 and 200, instead of 90 and 120.

$$Q_{31}Q_{21}A = \begin{bmatrix} .6 & 0 & .8 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ -.8 & 0 & .6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 150 & . & . \\ 0 & . & . \\ 200 & . & . \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 250 & -125 & 250 \\ 0 & 75 & -225 \\ 0 & 100 & 325 \end{bmatrix}.$$

One more step to R . The $(3, 2)$ entry has to go. The numbers $\cos \theta$ and $\sin \theta$ now come from 75 and 100. The rotation is now in rows and columns 2 and 3:

$$Q_{32}Q_{31}Q_{21}A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & .6 & .8 \\ 0 & -.8 & .6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 250 & -125 & \cdot \\ 0 & 75 & \cdot \\ 0 & 100 & \cdot \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 250 & -125 & 250 \\ 0 & 125 & 125 \\ 0 & 0 & 375 \end{bmatrix}.$$

We have reached the upper triangular R . What is Q ? Move the plane rotations Q_{ij} to the other side to find $A = QR$ —just as you moved the elimination matrices E_{ij} to the other side to find $A = LU$:

$$Q_{32}Q_{31}Q_{21}A = R \quad \text{means} \quad A = (Q_{21}^{-1}Q_{31}^{-1}Q_{32}^{-1})R = QR. \quad (3)$$

The inverse of each Q_{ij} is Q_{ij}^T (rotation through $-\theta$). The inverse of E_{ij} was not an orthogonal matrix! LU and QR are similar but not the same.

Householder reflections are faster because each one clears out a whole column below the diagonal. Watch how the first column a_1 of A becomes column r_1 of R :

$$\begin{array}{l} \text{Reflection by } H_1 \\ H_1 = I - 2u_1u_1^T \end{array} \quad H_1 a_1 = \begin{bmatrix} \|a_1\| \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{or} \quad \begin{bmatrix} -\|a_1\| \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} = r_1. \quad (4)$$

The length was not changed, and u_1 is in the direction of $a_1 - r_1$. We have $n - 1$ entries in the unit vector u_1 to get $n - 1$ zeros in r_1 . (Rotations had one angle θ to get one zero.) When we reach column k , $n - k$ available choices in the unit vector u_k lead to $n - k$ zeros in r_k . We just store the u 's and r 's to know Q and R :

$$\text{Inverse of } H_i \text{ is } H_i \quad (H_{n-1} \dots H_1)A = R \quad \text{means} \quad A = (H_1 \dots H_{n-1})R = QR. \quad (5)$$

This is how LAPACK improves on Gram-Schmidt. Q is *exactly* orthogonal.

Section 9.3 explains how $A = QR$ is used in the other big computation of linear algebra—the *eigenvalue problem*. The factors QR are reversed to give $A_1 = RQ$ which is $Q^{-1}AQ$. Since A_1 is similar to A , the eigenvalues are unchanged. Then A_1 is factored into Q_1R_1 , and reversing the factors gives A_2 . Amazingly, the entries below the diagonal get smaller in $A_1, A_2, A_3, \dots$ and we can identify the eigenvalues. This is the “ QR method” for $Ax = \lambda x$, a big success of numerical linear algebra.

Problem Set 9.1

- 1 Find the two pivots with and without row exchange to maximize the pivot:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} .001 & 0 \\ 1 & 1000 \end{bmatrix}.$$

With row exchanges to maximize pivots, why are no entries of L larger than 1? Find a 3 by 3 matrix A with all $|a_{ij}| \leq 1$ and $|\ell_{ij}| \leq 1$ but third pivot = 4.

- 2 Compute the exact inverse of the Hilbert matrix A by elimination. Then compute A^{-1} again by rounding all numbers to three figures:

Ill-conditioned matrix $A = \text{hilb}(3) = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{3} \\ \frac{1}{2} & \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{4} \\ \frac{1}{3} & \frac{1}{4} & \frac{1}{5} \end{bmatrix}.$

- 3 For the same A compute $\mathbf{b} = A\mathbf{x}$ for $\mathbf{x} = (1, 1, 1)$ and $\mathbf{x} = (0, 6, -3.6)$. A small change $\Delta\mathbf{b}$ produces a large change $\Delta\mathbf{x}$.
- 4 Find the eigenvalues (by computer) of the 8 by 8 Hilbert matrix $a_{ij} = 1/(i + j - 1)$. In the equation $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ with $\|\mathbf{b}\| = 1$, how large can $\|\mathbf{x}\|$ be? If $\mathbf{b}$ has roundoff error less than 10^{-16} , how large an error can this cause in $\mathbf{x}$? See Section 9.2.
- 5 For back substitution with a band matrix (width w), show that the number of multiplications to solve $U\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{c}$ is approximately wn .
- 6 If you know L and U and Q and R , is it faster to solve $LU\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ or $QR\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$?
- 7 Show that the number of multiplications to invert an upper triangular n by n matrix is about $\frac{1}{6}n^3$. Use back substitution on the columns of I , upward from 1's.
- 8 Choosing the largest available pivot in each column (partial pivoting), factor each A into $PA = LU$:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ 2 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 2 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 9 Put 1's on the three central diagonals of a 4 by 4 tridiagonal matrix. Find the cofactors of the six zero entries. Those entries are nonzero in A^{-1} .
- 10 (Suggested by C. Van Loan.) Find the LU factorization and solve by elimination when $\varepsilon = 10^{-3}, 10^{-6}, 10^{-9}, 10^{-12}, 10^{-15}$:

$$\begin{bmatrix} \varepsilon & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 + \varepsilon \\ 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The true $\mathbf{x}$ is $(1, 1)$. Make a table to show the error for each ε . Exchange the two equations and solve again—the errors should almost disappear.

- 11 (a) Choose $\sin \theta$ and $\cos \theta$ to triangularize A , and find R :

Givens rotation $Q_{21}A = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 \\ 3 & 5 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} * & * \\ 0 & * \end{bmatrix} = R.$

- (b) Choose $\sin \theta$ and $\cos \theta$ to make QAQ^{-1} triangular. What are the eigenvalues?

- 12 When A is multiplied by a plane rotation Q_{ij} , which n^2 entries of A are changed? When $Q_{ij}A$ is multiplied on the right by Q_{ij}^{-1} , which entries are changed now?
- 13 How many multiplications and how many additions are used to compute $Q_{ij}A$? Careful organization of the whole sequence of rotations gives $\frac{2}{3}n^3$ multiplications and $\frac{2}{3}n^3$ additions—the same as for QR by reflectors and twice as many as for LU .

Challenge Problems

- 14 (**Turning a robot hand**) The robot produces any 3 by 3 rotation A from plane rotations around the x, y, z axes. Then $Q_{32}Q_{31}Q_{21}A = R$, where A is orthogonal so R is I ! The three robot turns are in $A = Q_{21}^{-1}Q_{31}^{-1}Q_{32}^{-1}$. The three angles are “Euler angles” and $\det Q = 1$ to avoid reflection. Start by choosing $\cos \theta$ and $\sin \theta$ so that

$$Q_{21}A = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta & 0 \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \frac{1}{3} \begin{bmatrix} -1 & 2 & 2 \\ 2 & -1 & 2 \\ 2 & 2 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \text{ is zero in the } (2, 1) \text{ position.}$$

- 15 Create the 10 by 10 second difference matrix $K = \text{toeplitz}([2 - 1 \text{ zeros}(1, 8)])$. Permute rows and columns randomly by $KK = K(\text{randperm}(10), \text{randperm}(10))$. Factor by $[L, U] = \text{lu}(K)$ and $[LL, UU] = \text{lu}(KK)$, and count nonzeros by $\text{nnz}(L)$ and $\text{nnz}(LL)$. In this case L is in perfect tridiagonal order, but not LL .
- 16 Another ordering for this matrix K colors the meshpoints alternately red and black. This permutation P changes the normal $1, \dots, 10$ to $1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 2, 4, 6, 8, 10$:

$$\text{Red-black ordering} \quad PKP^T = \begin{bmatrix} 2I & D \\ D^T & 2I \end{bmatrix}. \quad \text{Find the matrix } D.$$

So many interesting experiments are possible. If you send good ideas they can go on the linear algebra website math.mit.edu/linearalgebra. I also recommend learning the command $B = \text{sparse}(A)$, after which $\text{find}(B)$ will list the nonzero entries and $\text{lu}(B)$ will factor B using that sparse format for L and U . Only the nonzeros are computed, where ordinary (dense) MATLAB computes all the zeros too.

- 17 Jeff Stuart has created a student activity that brilliantly demonstrates ill-conditioning:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1.0001 \\ 1 & 1.0000 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 3.0001 + e \\ 3.0000 + E \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{array}{ll} \text{With errors} & x = 2 - 10000(e - E) \\ e \text{ and } E & y = 1 + 10000(e - E) \end{array}$$

The algebra shows how errors e and E are amplified by 10000 unless $e = E$.

As always, the solution of a 2 by 2 system is the meeting point of two lines. The neat idea is to replace mathematical lines by *long sticks held by students*. The sticks for these two equations are almost parallel, and A is almost singular. Perpendicular sticks come from well-conditioned equations.

In Stuart's *Shake a Stick* activity, the students plot where the sticks cross (after multiple shakes). See www.plu.edu/~stuartjl for the wild movements of that crossing point (x, y) , when the sticks are nearly parallel.

9.2 Norms and Condition Numbers

How do we measure the size of a matrix? For a vector, the length is $\|x\|$. For a matrix, *the norm is* $\|A\|$. This word “*norm*” is sometimes used for vectors, instead of length. It is always used for matrices, and there are many ways to measure $\|A\|$. We look at the requirements on all “matrix norms” and then choose one.

Frobenius squared all the $|a_{ij}|^2$ and added; his norm $\|A\|_F$ is the square root. This treats A like a long vector with n^2 components: sometimes useful, but not the choice here.

I prefer to start with a vector norm. The triangle inequality says that $\|x + y\|$ is not greater than $\|x\| + \|y\|$. The length of $2x$ or $-2x$ is doubled to $2\|x\|$. The same rules will apply to matrix norms:

$$\|A + B\| \leq \|A\| + \|B\| \quad \text{and} \quad \|cA\| = |c| \|A\|. \quad (1)$$

The second requirements for a matrix norm are new, because matrices multiply. The norm $\|A\|$ controls the growth from x to Ax , and from B to AB :

$$\text{Growth factor } \|A\| \quad \|Ax\| \leq \|A\| \|x\| \quad \text{and} \quad \|AB\| \leq \|A\| \|B\|. \quad (2)$$

This leads to a natural way to define $\|A\|$, the norm of a matrix:

$$\text{The norm of } A \text{ is the largest ratio } \|Ax\|/\|x\|: \quad \|A\| = \max_{x \neq 0} \frac{\|Ax\|}{\|x\|}. \quad (3)$$

$\|Ax\|/\|x\|$ is never larger than $\|A\|$ (its maximum). This says that $\|Ax\| \leq \|A\| \|x\|$.

Example 1 If A is the identity matrix I , the ratios are $\|x\|/\|x\|$. Therefore $\|I\| = 1$. If A is an orthogonal matrix Q , lengths are again preserved: $\|Qx\| = \|x\|$. The ratios still give $\|Q\| = 1$. An orthogonal Q is good to compute with: errors don't grow.

Example 2 The norm of a diagonal matrix is its largest entry (using absolute values):

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has norm } \|A\| = 3. \quad \text{The eigenvector } x = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has } Ax = 3x.$$

The eigenvalue is 3. For this A (but not all A), the largest eigenvalue equals the norm.

For a positive definite symmetric matrix the norm is $\|A\| = \lambda_{\max}(A)$.

Choose x to be the eigenvector with maximum eigenvalue. Then $\|Ax\|/\|x\|$ equals $\lambda_{\max}$. The point is that no other x can make the ratio larger. The matrix is $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$, and the orthogonal matrices Q and Q^T leave lengths unchanged. So the ratio to maximize is really $\|\Lambda x\|/\|x\|$. The norm is the largest eigenvalue in the diagonal Λ .

Symmetric matrices Suppose A is symmetric but not positive definite. $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$ is still true. Then the norm is the largest of $|\lambda_1|, |\lambda_2|, \dots, |\lambda_n|$. We take absolute values,

because the norm is only concerned with length. For an eigenvector $\|Ax\| = \|\lambda x\| = |\lambda|$ times $\|x\|$. The x that gives the maximum ratio is the eigenvector for the maximum $|\lambda|$.

Unsymmetric matrices If A is not symmetric, its eigenvalues may not measure its true size. *The norm can be larger than any eigenvalue.* A very unsymmetric example has $\lambda_1 = \lambda_2 = 0$ but its norm is not zero:

$$\|A\| > \lambda_{\max} \quad A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has norm} \quad \|A\| = \max_{x \neq 0} \frac{\|Ax\|}{\|x\|} = 2.$$

The vector $x = (0, 1)$ gives $Ax = (2, 0)$. The ratio of lengths is $2/1$. This is the maximum ratio $\|A\|$, even though x is not an eigenvector.

It is the *symmetric matrix* $A^T A$, not the unsymmetric A , that has eigenvector $x = (0, 1)$. The norm is really decided by *the largest eigenvalue of* $A^T A$:

The norm of A (symmetric or not) is the square root of $\lambda_{\max}(A^T A)$:

$$\|A\|^2 = \max_{x \neq 0} \frac{\|Ax\|^2}{\|x\|^2} = \max_{x \neq 0} \frac{x^T A^T A x}{x^T x} = \lambda_{\max}(A^T A). \quad (4)$$

The unsymmetric example with $\lambda_{\max}(A) = 0$ has $\lambda_{\max}(A^T A) = 4$:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \text{ leads to } A^T A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 4 \end{bmatrix} \text{ with } \lambda_{\max} = 4. \text{ So the norm is } \|A\| = \sqrt{4}.$$

For any A Choose x to be the eigenvector of $A^T A$ with largest eigenvalue $\lambda_{\max}$. The ratio in equation (4) is $x^T A^T A x = x^T (\lambda_{\max}) x$ divided by $x^T x$. This is $\lambda_{\max}$.

No x can give a larger ratio. The symmetric matrix $A^T A$ has eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$ and orthonormal eigenvectors $q_1, q_2, \dots, q_n$. Every x is a combination of those vectors. Try this combination in the ratio and remember that $q_i^T q_j = 0$:

$$\frac{x^T A^T A x}{x^T x} = \frac{(c_1 q_1 + \dots + c_n q_n)^T (c_1 \lambda_1 q_1 + \dots + c_n \lambda_n q_n)}{(c_1 q_1 + \dots + c_n q_n)^T (c_1 q_1 + \dots + c_n q_n)} = \frac{c_1^2 \lambda_1 + \dots + c_n^2 \lambda_n}{c_1^2 + \dots + c_n^2}.$$

The maximum ratio $\lambda_{\max}$ is when all c 's are zero, except the one that multiplies $\lambda_{\max}$.

Note 1 The ratio in equation (4) is the *Rayleigh quotient* for the symmetric matrix $A^T A$. Its maximum is the largest eigenvalue $\lambda_{\max}(A^T A)$. The minimum ratio is $\lambda_{\min}(A^T A)$. If you substitute any vector x into the Rayleigh quotient $x^T A^T A x / x^T x$, you are guaranteed to get a number between $\lambda_{\min}(A^T A)$ and $\lambda_{\max}(A^T A)$.

Note 2 The norm $\|A\|$ equals the *largest singular value* $\sigma_{\max}$ of A . The singular values $\sigma_1, \dots, \sigma_r$ are the square roots of the positive eigenvalues of $A^T A$. So certainly $\sigma_{\max} = (\lambda_{\max})^{1/2}$. Since U and V are orthogonal in $A = U \Sigma V^T$, the norm is $\|A\| = \sigma_{\max}$.

The Condition Number of A

Section 9.1 showed that roundoff error can be serious. Some systems are sensitive, others are not so sensitive. The sensitivity to error is measured by the *condition number*. This is the first chapter in the book which intentionally introduces errors. We want to estimate how much they change x .

The original equation is $Ax = b$. Suppose the right side is changed to $b + \Delta b$ because of roundoff or measurement error. The solution is then changed to $x + \Delta x$. Our goal is to estimate the change Δx in the solution from the change Δb in the equation. Subtraction gives the *error equation* $A(\Delta x) = \Delta b$:

$$\text{Subtract } Ax = b \text{ from } A(x + \Delta x) = b + \Delta b \text{ to find } A(\Delta x) = \Delta b. \quad (5)$$

The error is $\Delta x = A^{-1}\Delta b$. It is large when A^{-1} is large (then A is nearly singular). The error Δx is especially large when Δb points in the worst direction—which is amplified most by A^{-1} . *The worst error has* $\|\Delta x\| = \|A^{-1}\| \|\Delta b\|$.

This error bound $\|A^{-1}\|$ has one serious drawback. If we multiply A by 1000, then A^{-1} is divided by 1000. The matrix looks a thousand times better. But a simple rescaling cannot change the reality of the problem. It is true that Δx will be divided by 1000, but so will the exact solution $x = A^{-1}b$. The *relative error* $\|\Delta x\|/\|x\|$ will stay the same. It is this relative change in x that should be compared to the relative change in b .

Comparing relative errors will now lead to the “condition number” $c = \|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$. Multiplying A by 1000 does not change this number, because A^{-1} is divided by 1000 and the condition number c stays the same. It measures the sensitivity of $Ax = b$.

The solution error is less than $c = \|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$ times the problem error:

$$\text{Condition number } c: \quad \frac{\|\Delta x\|}{\|x\|} \leq c \frac{\|\Delta b\|}{\|b\|}. \quad (6)$$

If the problem error is ΔA (error in A instead of b), still c controls Δx :

$$\text{Error } \Delta A \text{ in } A: \quad \frac{\|\Delta x\|}{\|x + \Delta x\|} \leq c \frac{\|\Delta A\|}{\|A\|}. \quad (7)$$

Proof The original equation is $b = Ax$. The error equation (5) is $\Delta x = A^{-1}\Delta b$. Apply the key property $\|Ax\| \leq \|A\| \|x\|$ of matrix norms:

$$\|b\| \leq \|A\| \|x\| \quad \text{and} \quad \|\Delta x\| \leq \|A^{-1}\| \|\Delta b\|.$$

Multiply the left sides to get $\|b\| \|\Delta x\|$, and multiply the right sides to get $c \|x\| \|\Delta b\|$. Divide both sides by $\|b\| \|x\|$. The left side is now the relative error $\|\Delta x\|/\|x\|$. The right side is now the upper bound in equation (6).

The same condition number $c = \|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$ appears when the error is in the matrix. We have ΔA instead of $\Delta \mathbf{b}$ in the error equation:

Subtract $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ from $(A + \Delta A)(\mathbf{x} + \Delta \mathbf{x}) = \mathbf{b}$ to find $A(\Delta \mathbf{x}) = -(\Delta A)(\mathbf{x} + \Delta \mathbf{x})$.

Multiply the last equation by A^{-1} and take norms to reach equation (7):

$$\|\Delta \mathbf{x}\| \leq \|A^{-1}\| \|\Delta A\| \|\mathbf{x} + \Delta \mathbf{x}\| \quad \text{or} \quad \frac{\|\Delta \mathbf{x}\|}{\|\mathbf{x} + \Delta \mathbf{x}\|} \leq \|A\| \|A^{-1}\| \frac{\|\Delta A\|}{\|A\|}.$$

Conclusion Errors enter in two ways. They begin with an error ΔA or $\Delta \mathbf{b}$ —a wrong matrix or a wrong $\mathbf{b}$. This problem error is amplified (a lot or a little) into the solution error $\Delta \mathbf{x}$. That error is bounded, relative to $\mathbf{x}$ itself, by the condition number c .

The error $\Delta \mathbf{b}$ depends on computer roundoff and on the original measurements of $\mathbf{b}$. The error ΔA also depends on the elimination steps. Small pivots tend to produce large errors in L and U . Then $L + \Delta L$ times $U + \Delta U$ equals $A + \Delta A$. When ΔA or the condition number is very large, the error $\Delta \mathbf{x}$ can be unacceptable.

Example 3 When A is symmetric, $c = \|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$ comes from the eigenvalues:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 6 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \text{ has norm } 6. \quad A^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{6} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{2} \end{bmatrix} \text{ has norm } \frac{1}{2}.$$

This A is symmetric positive definite. Its norm is $\lambda_{\max} = 6$. The norm of A^{-1} is $1/\lambda_{\min} = \frac{1}{2}$. Multiplying norms gives the *condition number* $\|A\| \|A^{-1}\| = \lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}$:

$$\text{Condition number for positive definite } A \quad c = \frac{\lambda_{\max}}{\lambda_{\min}} = \frac{6}{2} = 3.$$

Example 4 Keep the same A , with eigenvalues 6 and 2. To make $\mathbf{x}$ small, choose $\mathbf{b}$ along the first eigenvector $(1, 0)$. To make $\Delta \mathbf{x}$ large, choose $\Delta \mathbf{b}$ along the second eigenvector $(0, 1)$. Then $\mathbf{x} = \frac{1}{6}\mathbf{b}$ and $\Delta \mathbf{x} = \frac{1}{2}\Delta \mathbf{b}$. The ratio $\|\Delta \mathbf{x}\|/\|\mathbf{x}\|$ is exactly $c = 3$ times the ratio $\|\Delta \mathbf{b}\|/\|\mathbf{b}\|$.

This shows that the worst error allowed by the condition number $\|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$ can actually happen. Here is a useful rule of thumb, experimentally verified for Gaussian elimination: *The computer can lose $\log c$ decimal places to roundoff error.*

Problem Set 9.2

- 1 Find the norms $\|A\| = \lambda_{\max}$ and condition numbers $c = \lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}$ of these positive definite matrices:

$$\begin{bmatrix} .5 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 2 Find the norms and condition numbers from the square roots of $\lambda_{\max}(A^T A)$ and $\lambda_{\min}(A^T A)$. Without positive definiteness in A , we go to $A^T A$!

$$\begin{bmatrix} -2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 3 Explain these two inequalities from the definitions (3) of $\|A\|$ and $\|B\|$:

$$\|ABx\| \leq \|A\| \|Bx\| \leq \|A\| \|B\| \|x\|.$$

From the ratio of $\|ABx\|$ to $\|x\|$, deduce that $\|AB\| \leq \|A\| \|B\|$. This is the key to using matrix norms. The norm of A^n is never larger than $\|A\|^n$.

- 4 Use $\|AA^{-1}\| \leq \|A\| \|A^{-1}\|$ to prove that the condition number is at least 1.
- 5 Why is I the only symmetric positive definite matrix that has $\lambda_{\max} = \lambda_{\min} = 1$? Then the only other matrices with $\|A\| = 1$ and $\|A^{-1}\| = 1$ must have $A^T A = I$. Those are _____ matrices: perfectly conditioned.
- 6 Orthogonal matrices have norm $\|Q\| = 1$. If $A = QR$ show that $\|A\| \leq \|R\|$ and also $\|R\| \leq \|A\|$. Then $\|A\| = \|Q\| \|R\|$. Find an example of $A = LU$ with $\|A\| < \|L\| \|U\|$.
- 7 (a) Which famous inequality gives $\|(A+B)x\| \leq \|Ax\| + \|Bx\|$ for every x ?
(b) Why does the definition (3) of matrix norms lead to $\|A+B\| \leq \|A\| + \|B\|$?
- 8 Show that if λ is any eigenvalue of A , then $|\lambda| \leq \|A\|$. Start from $Ax = \lambda x$.
- 9 The “spectral radius” $\rho(A) = |\lambda_{\max}|$ is the largest absolute value of the eigenvalues. Show with 2 by 2 examples that $\rho(A+B) \leq \rho(A) + \rho(B)$ and $\rho(AB) \leq \rho(A)\rho(B)$ can both be *false*. The spectral radius is not acceptable as a norm.
- 10 (a) Explain why A and A^{-1} have the same condition number.
(b) Explain why A and A^T have the same norm, based on $\lambda(A^T A)$ and $\lambda(AA^T)$.
- 11 Estimate the condition number of the ill-conditioned matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 1.0001 \end{bmatrix}$.
- 12 Why is the determinant of A no good as a norm? Why is it no good as a condition number?
- 13 (Suggested by C. Moler and C. Van Loan.) Compute $b - Ay$ and $b - Az$ when

$$b = \begin{bmatrix} .217 \\ .254 \end{bmatrix} \quad A = \begin{bmatrix} .780 & .563 \\ .913 & .659 \end{bmatrix} \quad y = \begin{bmatrix} .341 \\ -.087 \end{bmatrix} \quad z = \begin{bmatrix} .999 \\ -1.0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Is y closer than z to solving $Ax = b$? Answer in two ways: Compare the *residual* $b - Ay$ to $b - Az$. Then compare y and z to the true $x = (1, -1)$. Both answers can be right. Sometimes we want a small residual, sometimes a small Δx .

- 14 (a) Compute the determinant of A in Problem 13. Compute A^{-1} .
(b) If possible compute $\|A\|$ and $\|A^{-1}\|$ and show that $c > 10^6$.

Problems 15–19 are about vector norms other than the usual $\|x\| = \sqrt{x \cdot x}$.

- 15 The “ ℓ^1 norm” and the “ ℓ^∞ norm” of $x = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$ are

$$\|x\|_1 = |x_1| + \dots + |x_n| \quad \text{and} \quad \|x\|_\infty = \max_{1 \leq i \leq n} |x_i|.$$

Compute the norms $\|x\|$ and $\|x\|_1$ and $\|x\|_\infty$ of these two vectors in $\mathbf{R}^5$:

$$x = (1, 1, 1, 1, 1) \quad x = (.1, .7, .3, .4, .5).$$

- 16 Prove that $\|x\|_\infty \leq \|x\| \leq \|x\|_1$. Show from the Schwarz inequality that the ratios $\|x\|/\|x\|_\infty$ and $\|x\|_1/\|x\|$ are never larger than $\sqrt{n}$. Which vector $(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ gives ratios equal to $\sqrt{n}$?
- 17 All vector norms must satisfy the *triangle inequality*. Prove that

$$\|x + y\|_\infty \leq \|x\|_\infty + \|y\|_\infty \quad \text{and} \quad \|x + y\|_1 \leq \|x\|_1 + \|y\|_1.$$

- 18 Vector norms must also satisfy $\|cx\| = |c| \|x\|$. The norm must be positive except when $x = 0$. Which of these are norms for vectors (x_1, x_2) in $\mathbf{R}^2$?

$$\|x\|_A = |x_1| + 2|x_2| \quad \|x\|_B = \min(|x_1|, |x_2|)$$

$$\|x\|_C = \|x\| + \|x\|_\infty \quad \|x\|_D = \|Ax\| \quad (\text{this answer depends on } A).$$

Challenge Problems

- 19 Show that $x^T y \leq \|x\|_1 \|y\|_\infty$ by choosing components $y_i = \pm 1$ to make $x^T y$ as large as possible.
- 20 The eigenvalues of the $-1, 2, -1$ difference matrix K are $\lambda = 2 - 2 \cos(j\pi/n + 1)$. Estimate $\lambda_{\min}$ and $\lambda_{\max}$ and $c = \text{cond}(K) = \lambda_{\max}/\lambda_{\min}$ as n increases: $c \approx Cn^2$ with what constant C ?

Test this estimate with $\text{eig}(K)$ and $\text{cond}(K)$ for $n = 10, 100, 1000$.

- 21 For unsymmetric matrices, the spectral radius $\rho = \max |\lambda_i|$ is not a norm (Problem 9). But still $\|A^n\|$ grows or decays like ρ^n for large n . Compare those numbers for $A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 \\ 0 & 1.1 \end{bmatrix}$ using the command **norm**.

In particular $A^n \rightarrow 0$ when $\rho < 1$. This is the key to Section 9.3 with $A = S^{-1}T$.

9.3 Iterative Methods and Preconditioners

Up to now, our approach to $Ax = b$ has been direct. We accepted A as it came. We attacked it by elimination with row exchanges. This section is about *iterative methods*, which replace A by a simpler matrix S . The difference $T = S - A$ is moved over to the right side of the equation. The problem becomes easier to solve, with S instead of A . But there is a price—the simpler system has to be solved over and over.

An iterative method is easy to invent. Just split A (carefully) into $S - T$.

$$\text{Rewrite } Ax = b \quad Sx = Tx + b. \quad (1)$$

The novelty is to solve (1) iteratively. Each guess x_k leads to the next x_{k+1} :

$$\text{Pure iteration} \quad Sx_{k+1} = Tx_k + b. \quad (2)$$

Start with any x_0 . Then solve $Sx_1 = Tx_0 + b$. Continue to the second iteration $Sx_2 = Tx_1 + b$. A hundred iterations are very common—often more. Stop when (and if!) the new vector x_{k+1} is sufficiently close to x_k —or when the **residual** $r_k = b - Ax_k$ is near zero. We choose the stopping test. Our hope is to get near the true solution, more quickly than by elimination. When the sequence x_k converges, its limit $x = x_\infty$ does solve equation (1). The proof is to let $k \rightarrow \infty$ in equation (2).

The two goals of the splitting $A = S - T$ are *speed per step* and *fast convergence*. The speed of each step depends on S and the speed of convergence depends on $S^{-1}T$:

- 1 Equation (2) should be easy to solve for x_{k+1} . The “*preconditioner*” S could be the diagonal or triangular part of A . A fast way uses $S = L_0U_0$, where those factors have many zeros compared to the exact $A = LU$. This is “*incomplete LU*”.
- 2 The difference $x - x_k$ (this is the error e_k) should go quickly to zero. Subtracting equation (2) from (1) cancels b , and it leaves the *equation for the error* e_k :

$$\text{Error equation} \quad Se_{k+1} = Te_k \text{ which means } e_{k+1} = S^{-1}Te_k. \quad (3)$$

At every step the error is multiplied by $S^{-1}T$. If $S^{-1}T$ is small, its powers go quickly to zero. But what is “small”?

The extreme splitting is $S = A$ and $T = 0$. Then the first step of the iteration is the original $Ax = b$. Convergence is perfect and $S^{-1}T$ is zero. But the cost of that step is what we wanted to avoid. The choice of S is a battle between speed per step (a simple S) and fast convergence (S close to A). Here are some popular choices:

J S = diagonal part of A (the iteration is called *Jacobi’s method*)

GS S = lower triangular part of A including the diagonal (*Gauss-Seidel method*)

SOR S = combination of Jacobi and Gauss-Seidel (*successive overrelaxation*)

ILU S = approximate L times approximate U (*incomplete LU method*).

Our first question is pure linear algebra: *When do the x_k 's converge to x ?* The answer uncovers the number $|\lambda|_{\max}$ that controls convergence. In examples of **J** and **GS** and **SOR**, we will compute this “spectral radius” $|\lambda|_{\max}$. It is the largest eigenvalue of the *iteration matrix* $B = S^{-1}T$.

The Spectral Radius $\rho(B)$ Controls Convergence

Equation (3) is $e_{k+1} = S^{-1}Te_k$. Every iteration step multiplies the error by the same matrix $B = S^{-1}T$. The error after k steps is $e_k = B^k e_0$. *The error approaches zero if the powers of $B = S^{-1}T$ approach zero.* It is beautiful to see how the eigenvalues of B —the largest eigenvalue in particular—control the matrix powers B^k .

The powers B^k approach zero if and only if every eigenvalue of B has $|\lambda| < 1$. *The rate of convergence is controlled by the spectral radius of B : $\rho = \max |\lambda(B)|$.*

The test for convergence is $|\lambda|_{\max} < 1$. Real eigenvalues must lie between -1 and 1 . Complex eigenvalues $\lambda = a + ib$ must have $|\lambda|^2 = a^2 + b^2 < 1$. (Chapter 10 will discuss complex numbers.) The spectral radius “rho” is the largest distance from 0 to the eigenvalues $\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n$ of $B = S^{-1}T$. This is $\rho = |\lambda|_{\max}$.

To see why $|\lambda|_{\max} < 1$ is necessary, suppose the starting error e_0 happens to be an eigenvector of B . After one step the error is $Be_0 = \lambda e_0$. After k steps the error is $B^k e_0 = \lambda^k e_0$. If we start with an eigenvector, we continue with that eigenvector—and it grows or decays with the powers λ^k . *This factor λ^k goes to zero when $|\lambda| < 1$.* Since this condition is required of every eigenvalue, we need $\rho = |\lambda|_{\max} < 1$.

To see why $|\lambda|_{\max} < 1$ is sufficient for the error to approach zero, suppose e_0 is a combination of eigenvectors:

$$e_0 = c_1 x_1 + \dots + c_n x_n \quad \text{leads to} \quad e_k = c_1 (\lambda_1)^k x_1 + \dots + c_n (\lambda_n)^k x_n. \quad (4)$$

This is the point of eigenvectors! They grow independently, each one controlled by its eigenvalue. When we multiply by B , the eigenvector x_i is multiplied by λ_i . If all $|\lambda_i| < 1$ then equation (4) ensures that e_k goes to zero.

Example 1 $B = \begin{bmatrix} .6 & .5 \\ .6 & .5 \end{bmatrix}$ has $\lambda_{\max} = 1.1$ $B' = \begin{bmatrix} .6 & 1.1 \\ 0 & .5 \end{bmatrix}$ has $\lambda_{\max} = .6$

B^2 is 1.1 times B . Then B^3 is $(1.1)^2$ times B . The powers of B will blow up. Contrast with the powers of B' . The matrix $(B')^k$ has $(.6)^k$ and $(.5)^k$ on its diagonal. The off-diagonal entries also involve $\rho^k = (.6)^k$, which sets the speed of convergence.

Note There is a technical difficulty when B does not have n independent eigenvectors. (To produce this effect in B' , change .5 to .6.) The starting error e_0 may not be a combination of eigenvectors—there are too few for a basis. Then diagonalization is impossible and equation (4) is not correct. We turn to the *Jordan form* when eigenvectors are missing:

$$\text{Jordan form } J \quad B = MJM^{-1} \quad \text{and} \quad B^k = MJ^k M^{-1}. \quad (5)$$

Section 6.6 shows how J and J^k are made of “blocks” with one repeated eigenvalue:

$$\text{The powers of a 2 by 2 block in } J \text{ are } \begin{bmatrix} \lambda & 1 \\ 0 & \lambda \end{bmatrix}^k = \begin{bmatrix} \lambda^k & k\lambda^{k-1} \\ 0 & \lambda^k \end{bmatrix}.$$

If $|\lambda| < 1$ then these powers approach zero. The extra factor k from a double eigenvalue is overwhelmed by the decreasing factor λ^{k-1} . This applies to all Jordan blocks. A block of size $S + 1$ has $k^S \lambda^{k-S}$ in J^k , which also approaches zero when $|\lambda| < 1$.

Diagonalizable or not: Convergence $B^k \rightarrow 0$ and its speed depend on $\rho = |\lambda|_{\max} < 1$.

Jacobi versus Gauss-Seidel

We now solve a specific 2 by 2 problem. Watch for that number $|\lambda|_{\max}$.

$$Ax = b \quad \begin{array}{l} 2u - v = 4 \\ -u + 2v = -2 \end{array} \quad \text{has the solution} \quad \begin{bmatrix} u \\ v \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (6)$$

The first splitting is **Jacobi's method**. Keep the *diagonal* of A on the left side (this is S). Move the off-diagonal part of A to the right side (this is T). Then iterate:

$$\text{Jacobi iteration} \quad Sx_{k+1} = Tx_k + b \quad \begin{array}{l} 2u_{k+1} = v_k + 4 \\ 2v_{k+1} = u_k - 2. \end{array}$$

Start from $u_0 = v_0 = 0$. The first step finds $u_1 = 2$ and $v_1 = -1$. Keep going:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 3/2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -1/4 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 15/8 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ -1/16 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{approaches} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This shows convergence. At steps 1, 3, 5 the second component is $-1, -1/4, -1/16$. The error is multiplied by $\frac{1}{4}$ every two steps. The components 0, $3/2, 15/8$ have errors 2, $\frac{1}{2}, \frac{1}{8}$. Those also drop by 4 in each two steps. *The error equation is* $Se_{k+1} = Te_k$:

$$\text{Error equation} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} e_{k+1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} e_k \quad \text{or} \quad e_{k+1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & 0 \end{bmatrix} e_k. \quad (7)$$

That last matrix $S^{-1}T$ has eigenvalues $\frac{1}{2}$ and $-\frac{1}{2}$. So its spectral radius is $\rho(B) = \frac{1}{2}$:

$$B = S^{-1}T = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has } |\lambda|_{\max} = \frac{1}{2} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{2} \\ \frac{1}{2} & 0 \end{bmatrix}^2 = \begin{bmatrix} \frac{1}{4} & 0 \\ 0 & \frac{1}{4} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Two steps multiply the error by $\frac{1}{4}$ exactly, in this special example. The important message is this: Jacobi's method works well when the main diagonal of A is large compared to the off-diagonal part. The diagonal part is S , the rest is $-T$. We want the diagonal to dominate and $S^{-1}T$ to be small.

The eigenvalue $\lambda = \frac{1}{2}$ is unusually small. Ten iterations reduce the error by $2^{10} = 1024$. More typical and more expensive is $|\lambda|_{\max} = .99$ or $.999$.

The **Gauss-Seidel method** keeps the whole lower triangular part of A as S :

$$\text{Gauss-Seidel} \quad \begin{array}{rcl} 2u_{k+1} & = & v_k + 4 \\ -u_{k+1} + 2v_{k+1} & = & -2 \end{array} \quad \text{or} \quad \begin{array}{rcl} u_{k+1} & = & \frac{1}{2}v_k + 2 \\ v_{k+1} & = & \frac{1}{2}u_{k+1} - 1. \end{array} \quad (8)$$

Notice the change. The new u_{k+1} from the first equation is used *immediately* in the second equation. With Jacobi, we saved the old u_k until the whole step was complete. With Gauss-Seidel, the new values enter right away and the old u_k is destroyed. This cuts the storage in half. It also speeds up the iteration (usually). And it costs no more than the Jacobi method.

Starting from $(0, 0)$, the exact answer $(2, 0)$ is reached in one step. That is an accident I did not expect. Test the iteration from another start $u_0 = 0$ and $v_0 = -1$:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -1 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 3/2 \\ -1/4 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 15/8 \\ -1/16 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 63/32 \\ -1/64 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{approaches} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 2 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The errors in the first component are $2, 1/2, 1/8, 1/32$. The errors in the second component are $-1, -1/4, -1/16, -1/32$. We divide by 4 in *one step* not two steps. **Gauss-Seidel is twice as fast as Jacobi**. We have $\rho_{GS} = (\rho_J)^2$.

This double speed is true for every positive definite tridiagonal matrix. Anything is possible when A is strongly nonsymmetric—Jacobi is sometimes better, and both methods might fail. Our example is small and A is positive definite tridiagonal:

$$S = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 0 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad T = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{and} \quad S^{-1}T = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & \frac{1}{2} \\ 0 & \frac{1}{4} \end{bmatrix}.$$

The Gauss-Seidel eigenvalues are 0 and $\frac{1}{4}$. Compare with $\frac{1}{2}$ and $-\frac{1}{2}$ for Jacobi.

With a small push we can explain the **successive overrelaxation method (SOR)**. The new idea is to introduce a parameter ω (omega) into the iteration. Then choose this number ω to make the spectral radius of $S^{-1}T$ as small as possible.

Rewrite $Ax = b$ as $\omega Ax = \omega b$. The matrix S in **SOR** has the diagonal of the original A , but below the diagonal we use ωA . On the right side T is $S - \omega A$:

$$\text{SOR} \quad \begin{array}{rcl} 2u_{k+1} & = & (2 - 2\omega)u_k + \omega v_k + 4\omega \\ -\omega u_{k+1} + 2v_{k+1} & = & (2 - 2\omega)v_k - 2\omega. \end{array} \quad (9)$$

This looks more complicated to us, but the computer goes as fast as ever. Each new u_{k+1} from the first equation is used immediately to find v_{k+1} in the second equation. This is like Gauss-Seidel, with an adjustable number ω . The key matrix is $S^{-1}T$:

$$\text{SOR iteration matrix} \quad S^{-1}T = \begin{bmatrix} 1 - \omega & \frac{1}{2}\omega \\ \frac{1}{2}\omega(1 - \omega) & 1 - \omega + \frac{1}{4}\omega^2 \end{bmatrix}. \quad (10)$$

The determinant is $(1 - \omega)^2$. At the best ω , both eigenvalues turn out to equal $7 - 4\sqrt{3}$, which is close to $(\frac{1}{4})^2$. Therefore **SOR** is twice as fast as Gauss-Seidel in this example. In other examples **SOR** can converge ten or a hundred times as fast.

I will put on record the most valuable test matrix of order n . It is our favorite $-1, 2, -1$ tridiagonal matrix K . The diagonal is $2I$. Below and above are -1 's. Our example had $n = 2$, which leads to $\cos \frac{\pi}{3} = \frac{1}{2}$ as the Jacobi eigenvalue found above. Notice especially that this eigenvalue is squared for Gauss-Seidel:

The splittings of the $-1, 2, -1$ matrix K of order n yield these eigenvalues of B :

Jacobi ($S = 0, 2, 0$ matrix):

$$S^{-1}T \text{ has } |\lambda|_{\max} = \cos \frac{\pi}{n+1}$$

Gauss-Seidel ($S = -1, 2, 0$ matrix):

$$S^{-1}T \text{ has } |\lambda|_{\max} = \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{n+1} \right)^2$$

SOR (with the best ω):

$$S^{-1}T \text{ has } |\lambda|_{\max} = \left(\cos \frac{\pi}{n+1} \right)^2 / \left(1 + \sin \frac{\pi}{n+1} \right)^2.$$

Let me be clear: For the $-1, 2, -1$ matrix you should not use any of these iterations! Elimination is very fast (exact LU). Iterations are intended for large sparse matrices—when a high percentage of the entries are zero. The not good zeros are inside the band, which is wide. They become nonzero in the exact L and U , which is why elimination becomes expensive.

We mention one more splitting. The idea of “*incomplete LU*” is to set the small nonzeros in L and U *back to zero*. This leaves triangular matrices L_0 and U_0 which are again sparse. The splitting has $S = L_0 U_0$ on the left side. Each step is quick:

$$\text{Incomplete LU} \quad L_0 U_0 x_{k+1} = (L_0 U_0 - A) x_k + b.$$

On the right side we do sparse matrix-vector multiplications. Don't multiply L_0 times U_0 , those are matrices. Multiply x_k by U_0 and then multiply that vector by L_0 . On the left side we do forward and back substitutions. If $L_0 U_0$ is close to A , then $|\lambda|_{\max}$ is small. A few iterations will give a close answer.

Multigrid and Conjugate Gradients

I cannot leave the impression that Jacobi and Gauss-Seidel are great methods. Generally the “low-frequency” part of the error decays very slowly, and many iterations are needed. Here are two ideas that bring tremendous improvement. Multigrid can solve problems of size n in $O(n)$ steps. With a good preconditioner, conjugate gradients becomes one of the most popular and powerful algorithms in numerical linear algebra.

Multigrid Solve smaller problems (often coming from coarser grids and doubled step-sizes Δx and Δy). Each iteration will be cheaper and convergence will be faster. Then interpolate between the values computed on the coarse grid to get a quick and close head-start on the full-size problem. Multigrid might go 4 levels down and back.

Conjugate gradients An ordinary iteration like $\mathbf{x}_{k+1} = \mathbf{x}_k - A\mathbf{x}_k + \mathbf{b}$ involves multiplication by A at each step. If A is sparse, this is not too expensive: $A\mathbf{x}_k$ is what we are willing to do. It adds one more basis vector to the growing “Krylov spaces” that contain our approximations. But $\mathbf{x}_{k+1}$ is **not the best combination** of $\mathbf{x}_0, A\mathbf{x}_0, \dots, A^k\mathbf{x}_0$. The ordinary iterations are simple but far from optimal.

The conjugate gradient method chooses **the best combination** $\mathbf{x}_k$ at every step. The extra cost (beyond one multiplication by A) is not great. We will give the CG iteration, emphasizing that this method was created for a *symmetric positive definite matrix*. When A is not symmetric, one good choice is GMRES. When $A = A^T$ is not positive definite, there is MINRES. A world of high-powered iterative methods has been created around the idea of making optimal choices of each successive $\mathbf{x}_k$.

My textbook *Computational Science and Engineering* describes multigrid and CG in much more detail. Among books on numerical linear algebra, Trefethen-Bau is deservedly popular (others are terrific too). Golub-Van Loan is a level up.

The Problem Set reproduces the five steps in each conjugate gradient cycle from $\mathbf{x}_{k-1}$ to $\mathbf{x}_k$. We compute that new approximation $\mathbf{x}_k$, the new residual $\mathbf{r}_k = \mathbf{b} - A\mathbf{x}_k$, and the new search direction $\mathbf{d}_k$ to look for the next $\mathbf{x}_{k+1}$.

I wrote those steps for the original matrix A . But a **preconditioner** S can make convergence much faster. Our original equation is $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$. The preconditioned equation is $S^{-1}A\mathbf{x} = S^{-1}\mathbf{b}$. Small changes in the code give the *preconditioned conjugate gradient method*—the leading iterative method to solve positive definite systems.

The biggest competition is direct elimination, with the equations reordered to take maximum advantage of many zeros in A . It is not easy to outperform Gauss.

Iterative Methods for Eigenvalues

We move from $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ to $A\mathbf{x} = \lambda\mathbf{x}$. Iterations are an option for linear equations. They are a necessity for eigenvalue problems. The eigenvalues of an n by n matrix are the roots of an n th degree polynomial. The determinant of $A - \lambda I$ starts with $(-\lambda)^n$. This book must not leave the impression that eigenvalues should be computed that way! Working from $\det(A - \lambda I) = 0$ is a very poor approach—except when n is small.

For $n > 4$ there is no formula to solve $\det(A - \lambda I) = 0$. Worse than that, the λ 's can be very unstable and sensitive. It is much better to work with A itself, gradually making it diagonal or triangular. (Then the eigenvalues appear on the diagonal.) Good computer codes are available in the LAPACK library—individual routines are free on www.netlib.org/lapack. This library combines the earlier LINPACK and EISPACK, with many improvements (to use matrix-matrix operations in the Level 3 BLAS). It is a collection of Fortran 77 programs for linear algebra on high-performance computers. For your computer and mine, a high quality matrix package is all we need. For supercomputers with parallel processing, move to ScaLAPACK and block elimination.

We will briefly discuss the power method and the QR method (chosen by LAPACK) for computing eigenvalues. It makes no sense to give full details of the codes.

1 Power methods and inverse power methods. Start with any vector $\mathbf{u}_0$. Multiply by A to find $\mathbf{u}_1$. Multiply by A again to find $\mathbf{u}_2$. If $\mathbf{u}_0$ is a combination of the eigenvectors, then A multiplies each eigenvector $\mathbf{x}_i$ by λ_i . After k steps we have $(\lambda_i)^k$:

$$\mathbf{u}_k = A^k \mathbf{u}_0 = c_1(\lambda_1)^k \mathbf{x}_1 + \cdots + c_n(\lambda_n)^k \mathbf{x}_n. \quad (11)$$

As the power method continues, *the largest eigenvalue begins to dominate*. The vectors $\mathbf{u}_k$ point toward that dominant eigenvector. We saw this for Markov matrices in Chapter 8:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} .9 & .3 \\ .1 & .7 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has} \quad \lambda_{\max} = 1 \quad \text{with eigenvector} \quad \begin{bmatrix} .75 \\ .25 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Start with $\mathbf{u}_0$ and multiply at every step by A :

$$\mathbf{u}_0 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u}_1 = \begin{bmatrix} .9 \\ .1 \end{bmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{u}_2 = \begin{bmatrix} .84 \\ .16 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{is approaching} \quad \mathbf{u}_\infty = \begin{bmatrix} .75 \\ .25 \end{bmatrix}.$$

The speed of convergence depends on the *ratio* of the second largest eigenvalue λ_2 to the largest λ_1 . We don't want λ_1 to be small, we want λ_2/λ_1 to be small. Here $\lambda_2 = .6$ and $\lambda_1 = 1$, giving good speed. For large matrices it often happens that $|\lambda_2/\lambda_1|$ is very close to 1. Then the power method is too slow.

Is there a way to find the *smallest* eigenvalue—which is often the most important in applications? Yes, by the *inverse* power method: Multiply $\mathbf{u}_0$ by A^{-1} instead of A . Since we never want to compute A^{-1} , we actually solve $A\mathbf{u}_1 = \mathbf{u}_0$. By saving the LU factors, the next step $A\mathbf{u}_2 = \mathbf{u}_1$ is fast. Step k has $A\mathbf{u}_k = \mathbf{u}_{k-1}$:

$$\text{Inverse power method} \quad \mathbf{u}_k = A^{-k} \mathbf{u}_0 = \frac{c_1 \mathbf{x}_1}{(\lambda_1)^k} + \cdots + \frac{c_n \mathbf{x}_n}{(\lambda_n)^k}. \quad (12)$$

Now the *smallest* eigenvalue $\lambda_{\min}$ is in control. When it is very small, the factor $1/\lambda_{\min}^k$ is large. For high speed, we make $\lambda_{\min}$ even smaller by shifting the matrix to $A - \lambda^* I$.

That shift doesn't change the eigenvectors. (λ^* might come from the diagonal of A , even better is a Rayleigh quotient $\mathbf{x}^T A \mathbf{x} / \mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{x}$.) If λ^* is close to $\lambda_{\min}$ then $(A - \lambda^* I)^{-1}$ has the very large eigenvalue $(\lambda_{\min} - \lambda^*)^{-1}$. Each *shifted inverse power step* multiplies the eigenvector by this big number, and that eigenvector quickly dominates.

2 The QR Method This is a major achievement in numerical linear algebra. Fifty years ago, eigenvalue computations were slow and inaccurate. We didn't even realize that solving $\det(A - \lambda I) = 0$ was a terrible method. Jacobi had suggested earlier that A should gradually be made triangular—then the eigenvalues appear automatically on the diagonal. He used 2 by 2 rotations to produce off-diagonal zeros. (Unfortunately the previous zeros can become nonzero again. But Jacobi's method made a partial comeback with parallel computers.) At present the *QR method* is the leader in eigenvalue computations and we describe it briefly.

The basic step is to factor A , whose eigenvalues we want, into QR . Remember from Gram-Schmidt (Section 4.4) that Q has orthonormal columns and R is triangular. For eigenvalues the key idea is: *Reverse Q and R*. The new matrix (same λ 's) is $A_1 = RQ$.

The eigenvalues are not changed in RQ because $A = QR$ is similar to $A_1 = Q^{-1}AQ$:

$$A_1 = RQ \text{ has the same } \lambda \quad QRx = \lambda x \quad \text{gives} \quad RQ(Q^{-1}x) = \lambda(Q^{-1}x). \quad (13)$$

This process continues. Factor the new matrix A_1 into Q_1R_1 . Then reverse the factors to R_1Q_1 . This is the similar matrix A_2 and again no change in the eigenvalues. Amazingly, those eigenvalues begin to show up on the diagonal. Often the last entry of A_4 holds an accurate eigenvalue. In that case we remove the last row and column and continue with a smaller matrix to find the next eigenvalue.

Two extra ideas make this method a success. One is to shift the matrix by a multiple of I , before factoring into QR . Then RQ is shifted back:

Factor $A_k - c_kI$ into Q_kR_k . The next matrix is $A_{k+1} = R_kQ_k + c_kI$.

A_{k+1} has the same eigenvalues as A_k , and the same as the original $A_0 = A$. A good shift chooses c near an (unknown) eigenvalue. That eigenvalue appears more accurately on the diagonal of A_{k+1} —which tells us a better c for the next step to A_{k+2} .

The other idea is to obtain off-diagonal zeros before the QR method starts. An elimination step E will do it, or a Eivens rotation, but don't forget E^{-1} (to keep λ):

$$EAE^{-1} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & & \\ & 1 & \\ & -1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 & 5 \\ 1 & 6 & 7 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & & \\ & 1 & \\ & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 5 & 3 \\ 1 & 9 & 5 \\ 0 & 4 & 2 \end{bmatrix}. \text{ Same } \lambda\text{'s.}$$

We must leave those nonzeros 1 and 4 along *one subdiagonal*. More E 's could remove them, but E^{-1} would fill them in again. This is a "**Hessenberg matrix**" (one nonzero subdiagonal). The zeros in the lower left corner will stay zero through the QR method. The operation count for each QR factorization drops from $O(n^3)$ to $O(n^2)$.

Golub and Van Loan give this example of one shifted QR step on a Hessenberg matrix. The shift is $7I$, taking 7 from all diagonal entries (then shifting back for A_1):

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 2 & 3 \\ 4 & 5 & 6 \\ 0 & .001 & 7 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{leads to} \quad A_1 = \begin{bmatrix} -.54 & 1.69 & 0.835 \\ .31 & 6.53 & -6.656 \\ 0 & .00002 & 7.012 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Factoring $A - 7I$ into QR produced $A_1 = RQ + 7I$. Notice the very small number .00002. The diagonal entry 7.012 is almost an exact eigenvalue of A_1 , and therefore of A . Another QR step on A_1 with shift by $7.012I$ would give terrific accuracy.

For large sparse matrices I would look to ARPACK. Problems 27–29 describe the Arnoldi iteration that orthogonalizes the basis—each step has only three terms when A is symmetric. The matrix becomes tridiagonal and still orthogonally similar to the original A : a wonderful start for computing eigenvalues.

Problem Set 9.3

Problems 1–12 are about iterative methods for $Ax = b$.

- 1 Change $Ax = b$ to $x = (I - A)x + b$. What are S and T for this splitting? What matrix $S^{-1}T$ controls the convergence of $x_{k+1} = (I - A)x_k + b$?
- 2 If λ is an eigenvalue of A , then _____ is an eigenvalue of $B = I - A$. The real eigenvalues of B have absolute value less than 1 if the real eigenvalues of A lie between _____ and _____.
- 3 Show why the iteration $x_{k+1} = (I - A)x_k + b$ does not converge for $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$.
- 4 Why is the norm of B^k never larger than $\|B\|^k$? Then $\|B\| < 1$ guarantees that the powers B^k approach zero (convergence). No surprise since $|\lambda|_{\max}$ is below $\|B\|$.
- 5 If A is singular then all splittings $A = S - T$ must fail. From $Ax = 0$ show that $S^{-1}Tx = x$. So this matrix $B = S^{-1}T$ has $\lambda = 1$ and fails.
- 6 Change the 2's to 3's and find the eigenvalues of $S^{-1}T$ for Jacobi's method:

$$Sx_{k+1} = Tx_k + b \quad \text{is} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ 0 & 3 \end{bmatrix} x_{k+1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} x_k + b.$$

- 7 Find the eigenvalues of $S^{-1}T$ for the Gauss-Seidel method applied to Problem 6:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 \\ -1 & 3 \end{bmatrix} x_{k+1} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix} x_k + b.$$

Does $|\lambda|_{\max}$ for Gauss-Seidel equal $|\lambda|_{\max}^2$ for Jacobi?

- 8 For any 2 by 2 matrix $\begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ c & d \end{bmatrix}$ show that $|\lambda|_{\max}$ equals $|bc/ad|$ for Gauss-Seidel and $|bc/ad|^{1/2}$ for Jacobi. We need $ad \neq 0$ for the matrix S to be invertible.
- 9 The best ω produces two equal eigenvalues for $S^{-1}T$ in the **SOR** method. Those eigenvalues are $\omega - 1$ because the determinant is $(\omega - 1)^2$. Set the trace in equation (10) equal to $(\omega - 1) + (\omega - 1)$ and find this optimal ω .
- 10 Write a computer code (MATLAB or other) for the Gauss-Seidel method. You can define S and T from A , or set up the iteration loop directly from the entries a_{ij} . Test it on the $-1, 2, -1$ matrices A of order 10, 20, 50 with $b = (1, 0, \dots, 0)$.
- 11 The Gauss-Seidel iteration at component i uses earlier parts of x^{new} :

$$\text{Gauss-Seidel} \quad x_i^{\text{new}} = x_i^{\text{old}} + \frac{1}{a_{ii}} \left(b_i - \sum_{j=1}^{i-1} a_{ij} x_j^{\text{new}} - \sum_{j=i}^n a_{ij} x_j^{\text{old}} \right).$$

If every $x_i^{\text{new}} = x_i^{\text{old}}$ how does this show that the solution x is correct? How does the formula change for Jacobi's method? For **SOR** insert ω outside the parentheses.

- 12 The **SOR** splitting matrix S is the same as for Gauss-Seidel except that the diagonal is divided by ω . Write a program for **SOR** on an n by n matrix. Apply it with $\omega = 1, 1.4, 1.8, 2.2$ when A is the $-1, 2, -1$ matrix of order $n = 10$.
- 13 Divide equation (11) by λ_1^k and explain why $|\lambda_2/\lambda_1|$ controls the convergence of the power method. Construct a matrix A for which this method *does not converge*.
- 14 The Markov matrix $A = \begin{bmatrix} .9 & .3 \\ .1 & .7 \end{bmatrix}$ has $\lambda = 1$ and $.6$, and the power method $\mathbf{u}_k = A^k \mathbf{u}_0$ converges to $\begin{bmatrix} .75 \\ .25 \end{bmatrix}$. Find the eigenvectors of A^{-1} . What does the inverse power method $\mathbf{u}_{-k} = A^{-k} \mathbf{u}_0$ converge to (after you multiply by $.6^k$)?
- 15 The tridiagonal matrix of size $n - 1$ with diagonals $-1, 2, -1$ has eigenvalues $\lambda_j = 2 - 2\cos(j\pi/n)$. Why are the smallest eigenvalues approximately $(j\pi/n)^2$? The inverse power method converges at the speed $\lambda_1/\lambda_2 \approx 1/4$.
- 16 For $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 \\ -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$ apply the power method $\mathbf{u}_{k+1} = A\mathbf{u}_k$ three times starting with $\mathbf{u}_0 = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$. What eigenvector is the power method converging to?
- 17 In Problem 11 apply the *inverse* power method $\mathbf{u}_{k+1} = A^{-1}\mathbf{u}_k$ three times with the same $\mathbf{u}_0$. What eigenvector are the $\mathbf{u}_k$'s approaching?
- 18 In the QR method for eigenvalues, show that the $2, 1$ entry drops from $\sin \theta$ in $A = QR$ to $-\sin^3 \theta$ in RQ . (Compute R and RQ .) This "cubic convergence" makes the method a success:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & \sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & 0 \end{bmatrix} = QR = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & ? \\ 0 & ? \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 19 If A is an orthogonal matrix, its QR factorization has $Q = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and $R = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. Therefore $RQ = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. These are among the rare examples when the QR method goes nowhere.
- 20 The shifted QR method factors $A - cI$ into QR . Show that the next matrix $A_1 = RQ + cI$ equals $Q^{-1}AQ$. Therefore A_1 has the $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ eigenvalues as A (but is closer to triangular).
- 21 When $A = A^T$, the "*Lanczos method*" finds a 's and b 's and orthonormal $\mathbf{q}$'s so that $A\mathbf{q}_j = b_{j-1}\mathbf{q}_{j-1} + a_j\mathbf{q}_j + b_j\mathbf{q}_{j+1}$ (with $\mathbf{q}_0 = \mathbf{0}$). Multiply by $\mathbf{q}_j^T$ to find a formula for a_j . The equation says that $AQ = QT$ where T is a tridiagonal matrix.
- 22 The equation in Problem 21 develops from this loop with $b_0 = 1$ and $\mathbf{r}_0 = \text{any } \mathbf{q}_1$:

$$\mathbf{q}_{j+1} = \mathbf{r}_j/b_j; j = j+1; a_j = \mathbf{q}_j^T A \mathbf{q}_j; \mathbf{r}_j = A\mathbf{q}_j - b_{j-1}\mathbf{q}_{j-1} - a_j\mathbf{q}_j; b_j = \|\mathbf{r}_j\|.$$

Write a code and test it on the $-1, 2, -1$ matrix A . $Q^T Q$ should be I .

- 23** Suppose A is *tridiagonal and symmetric* in the QR method. From $A_1 = Q^{-1}AQ$ show that A_1 is symmetric. Write $A_1 = RAR^{-1}$ to show that A_1 is also tridiagonal. (If the lower part of A_1 is proved tridiagonal then by symmetry the upper part is too.)
Symmetric tridiagonal matrices are the best way to start in the QR method.

Questions 24–26 are about quick ways to estimate the location of the eigenvalues.

- 24** If the sum of $|a_{ij}|$ along every row is less than 1, explain this proof that $|\lambda| < 1$. Suppose $Ax = \lambda x$ and $|x_i|$ is larger than the other components of x . Then $|\sum a_{ij}x_j|$ is less than $|x_i|$. That means $|\lambda x_i| < |x_i|$ so $|\lambda| < 1$.

(Gershgorin circles) Every eigenvalue of A is in one or more of n circles. Each circle is centered at a diagonal entry a_{ii} with radius $r_i = \sum_{j \neq i} |a_{ij}|$.

This follows from $(\lambda - a_{ii})x_i = \sum_{j \neq i} a_{ij}x_j$. If $|x_i|$ is larger than the other components of x , this sum is at most $r_i|x_i|$. Dividing by $|x_i|$ leaves $|\lambda - a_{ii}| \leq r_i$.

- 25** What bound on $|\lambda|_{\max}$ does Problem 24 give for these matrices? What are the three Gershgorin circles that contain all the eigenvalues? Those circles show immediately that K is at least positive semidefinite (*actually definite*) and A has $\lambda_{\max} = 1$.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} .3 & .5 & .2 \\ .3 & .4 & .3 \\ .4 & .1 & .5 \end{bmatrix} \quad K = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 2 & -1 \\ 0 & -1 & 2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 26** These matrices are diagonally dominant because each $a_{ii} > r_i =$ absolute sum along the rest of row i . From the Gershgorin circles containing all λ 's, show that diagonally dominant matrices are invertible.

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & .3 & .4 \\ .3 & 1 & .5 \\ .4 & .5 & 1 \end{bmatrix} \quad A = \begin{bmatrix} 4 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 3 & 1 \\ 2 & 2 & 5 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Problems 27–30 present two fundamental iterations. Each step involves Aq or Ad .

The key point for large matrices is that **matrix-vector multiplication is much faster than matrix-matrix multiplication**. A crucial construction starts with a vector b . Repeated multiplication will produce $Ab, A^2b, \dots$ but those vectors are far from orthogonal. The “**Arnoldi iteration**” creates an orthonormal basis $q_1, q_2, \dots$ for the same space by the Gram-Schmidt idea: *orthogonalize each new Aq_n against the previous $q_1, \dots, q_{n-1}$* . The “Krylov space” spanned by $b, Ab, \dots, A^{n-1}b$ then has a much better basis $q_1, \dots, q_n$.

Here in pseudocode are two of the most important algorithms in numerical linear algebra: Arnoldi gives a good basis and CG gives a good approximation to $x = A^{-1}b$.

Arnoldi Iteration	Conjugate Gradient Iteration for Positive Definite A
$q_1 = b/\ b\ $	$x_0 = 0, r_0 = b, d_0 = r_0$
for $n = 1$ to $N - 1$	for $n = 1$ to N
$v = Aq_n$	$\alpha_n = (r_{n-1}^T r_{n-1}) / (d_{n-1}^T A d_{n-1})$ step length x_{n-1} to x_n
for $j = 1$ to n	$x_n = x_{n-1} + \alpha_n d_{n-1}$ approximate solution
$h_{jn} = q_j^T v$	$r_n = r_{n-1} - \alpha_n A d_{n-1}$ new residual $b - Ax_n$
$v = v - h_{jn} q_j$	$\beta_n = (r_n^T r_n) / (r_{n-1}^T r_{n-1})$ improvement this step
$h_{n+1,n} = \ v\ $	$d_n = r_n + \beta_n d_{n-1}$ next search direction
$q_{n+1} = v / h_{n+1,n}$	% Notice: only 1 matrix-vector multiplication Aq and Ad

For conjugate gradients, the residuals r_n are orthogonal and the search directions are A -orthogonal: all $d_j^T A d_k = 0$. The iteration solves $Ax = b$ by minimizing the error $e^T A e$ over all vectors in the Krylov subspace. It is a fantastic algorithm.

27 For the diagonal matrix $A = \text{diag}([1 \ 2 \ 3 \ 4])$ and the vector $b = (1, 1, 1, 1)$, go through one Arnoldi step to find the orthonormal vectors q_1 and q_2 .

28 Arnoldi's method is finding Q so that $AQ = QH$ (column by column):

$$AQ = \begin{bmatrix} Aq_1 & \cdots & Aq_N \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} q_1 & \cdots & q_N \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} h_{11} & h_{12} & \cdot & h_{1N} \\ h_{21} & h_{22} & \cdot & h_{2N} \\ 0 & h_{32} & \cdot & \cdot \\ 0 & 0 & \cdot & h_{NN} \end{bmatrix} = QH$$

H is a “Hessenberg matrix” with one nonzero subdiagonal. Here is the crucial fact when A is symmetric: **The matrix $H = Q^{-1}AQ = Q^T A Q$ is symmetric and therefore tridiagonal.** Explain that sentence.

29 This tridiagonal H (when A is symmetric) gives the **Lanczos iteration**:

$$\text{Three terms only} \quad q_{j+1} = (Aq_j - h_{j,j}q_j - h_{j-1,j}q_{j-1})/h_{j+1,j}$$

From $H = Q^{-1}AQ$, why are the eigenvalues of H the same as the eigenvalues of A ? For large matrices, the “Lanczos method” computes the leading eigenvalues by stopping at a smaller tridiagonal matrix H_k . The QR method in the text is applied to compute the eigenvalues of H_k .

30 Apply the conjugate gradient method to solve $Ax = b = \text{ones}(100, 1)$, where A is the $-1, 2, -1$ second difference matrix $A = \text{toeplitz}([2 \ -1 \ \text{zeros}(1, 98)])$. Graph x_{10} and x_{20} from CG, along with the exact solution x . (Its 100 components are $x_i = (ih - i^2 h^2)/2$ with $h = 1/101$. “**plot**($i, x(i)$)” should produce a parabola.)

Chapter 10

Complex Vectors and Matrices

10.1 Complex Numbers

A complete presentation of linear algebra must include complex numbers. Even when the matrix is real, *the eigenvalues and eigenvectors are often complex*. Example: A 2 by 2 rotation matrix has no real eigenvectors. Every vector in the plane turns by θ —its direction changes. But the rotation matrix has complex eigenvectors $(1, i)$ and $(1, -i)$.

Notice that those eigenvectors are connected by changing i to $-i$. For a real matrix, the eigenvectors come in “conjugate pairs.” The eigenvalues of rotation by θ are also conjugate complex numbers $e^{i\theta}$ and $e^{-i\theta}$. We must move from $\mathbf{R}^n$ to $\mathbf{C}^n$.

The second reason for allowing complex numbers goes beyond λ and x to the matrix A . *The matrix itself may be complex*. We will devote a whole section to the most important example—the *Fourier matrix*. Engineering and science and music and economics all use Fourier series. In reality the series is finite, not infinite. Computing the coefficients in $c_1 e^{ix} + c_2 e^{i2x} + \dots + c_n e^{inx}$ is a linear algebra problem.

This section gives the main facts about complex numbers. It is a review for some students and a reference for everyone. Everything comes from $i^2 = -1$. The Fast Fourier Transform applies the amazing formula $e^{2\pi i} = 1$. Add angles when $e^{i\theta}$ multiplies $e^{i\theta}$:

The square of $e^{2\pi i/4} = i$ is $e^{4\pi i/4} = -1$. The fourth power of $e^{2\pi i/4}$ is $e^{2\pi i} = 1$.

Adding and Multiplying Complex Numbers

Start with the imaginary number i . Everybody knows that $x^2 = -1$ has no real solution. When you square a real number, the answer is never negative. So the world has agreed on a solution called i . (Except that electrical engineers call it j .) Imaginary numbers follow the normal rules of addition and multiplication, with one difference. **Replace i^2 by -1 .**

A complex number (say $3 + 2i$) **is the sum of a real number (3) and a pure imaginary number ($2i$)**. Addition keeps the real and imaginary parts separate. Multiplication uses $i^2 = -1$:

$$\text{Add: } (3 + 2i) + (3 + 2i) = 6 + 4i$$

$$\text{Multiply: } (3 + 2i)(1 - i) = 3 + 2i - 3i - 2i^2 = 5 - i.$$

If I add $3 + i$ to $1 - i$, the answer is 4. The real numbers $3 + 1$ stay separate from the imaginary numbers $i - i$. We are adding the vectors $(3, 1)$ and $(1, -1)$.

The number $(1 + i)^2$ is $1 + i$ times $1 + i$. The rules give the surprising answer $2i$:

$$(1 + i)(1 + i) = 1 + i + i + i^2 = 2i.$$

In the complex plane, $1 + i$ is at an angle of 45° . It is like the vector $(1, 1)$. When we square $1 + i$ to get $2i$, the angle doubles to 90° . If we square again, the answer is $(2i)^2 = -4$. The 90° angle doubled to 180° , the direction of a negative real number.

A real number is just a complex number $z = a + bi$, with zero imaginary part: $b = 0$. A pure imaginary number has $a = 0$:

The **real part** is $a = \text{Re}(a + bi)$. The **imaginary part** is $b = \text{Im}(a + bi)$.

The Complex Plane

Complex numbers correspond to points in a plane. Real numbers go along the x axis. Pure imaginary numbers are on the y axis. **The complex number $3 + 2i$ is at the point with coordinates $(3, 2)$** . The number zero, which is $0 + 0i$, is at the origin.

Adding and subtracting complex numbers is like adding and subtracting vectors in the plane. The real component stays separate from the imaginary component. The vectors go head-to-tail as usual. The complex plane $\mathbb{C}^1$ is like the ordinary two-dimensional plane $\mathbb{R}^2$, except that we multiply complex numbers and we didn't multiply vectors.

Now comes an important idea. **The complex conjugate of $3 + 2i$ is $3 - 2i$** . The complex conjugate of $z = 1 - i$ is $\bar{z} = 1 + i$. In general the conjugate of $z = a + bi$ is $\bar{z} = a - bi$. (Some writers use a "bar" on the number and others use a "star": $\bar{z} = z^*$.) The imaginary parts of z and " z bar" have opposite signs. In the complex plane, $\bar{z}$ is the image of z on the other side of the real axis.

Two useful facts. **When we multiply conjugates $\bar{z}_1$ and $\bar{z}_2$, we get the conjugate of $z_1 z_2$** . When we add $\bar{z}_1$ and $\bar{z}_2$, we get the conjugate of $z_1 + z_2$:

$$\bar{z}_1 + \bar{z}_2 = (3 - 2i) + (1 + i) = 4 - i. \text{ This is the conjugate of } z_1 + z_2 = 4 + i.$$

$$\bar{z}_1 \times \bar{z}_2 = (3 - 2i) \times (1 + i) = 5 + i. \text{ This is the conjugate of } z_1 \times z_2 = 5 - i.$$

Adding and multiplying is exactly what linear algebra needs. By taking conjugates of $Ax = \lambda x$, when A is real, we have another eigenvalue $\bar{\lambda}$ and its eigenvector $\bar{x}$:

$$\text{If } Ax = \lambda x \text{ and } A \text{ is real then } A\bar{x} = \bar{\lambda}\bar{x}. \quad (1)$$

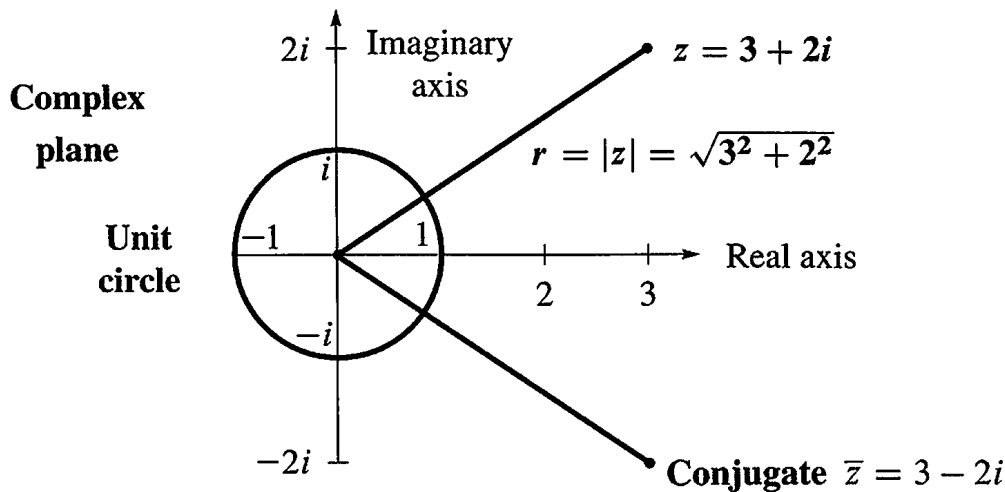


Figure 10.1: The number $z = a + bi$ corresponds to the point (a, b) and the vector $\begin{bmatrix} a \\ b \end{bmatrix}$.

Something special happens when $z = 3 + 2i$ combines with its own complex conjugate $\bar{z} = 3 - 2i$. The result from adding $z + \bar{z}$ or multiplying $z\bar{z}$ is always real:

$$\begin{aligned} z + \bar{z} &= \text{real} & (3 + 2i) + (3 - 2i) &= 6 \quad (\text{real}) \\ z\bar{z} &= \text{real} & (3 + 2i) \times (3 - 2i) &= 9 + 6i - 6i - 4i^2 = 13 \quad (\text{real}). \end{aligned}$$

The sum of $z = a + bi$ and its conjugate $\bar{z} = a - bi$ is the real number $2a$. The product of z times $\bar{z}$ is the real number $a^2 + b^2$:

$$\text{Multiply } z \text{ times } \bar{z} \qquad (a + bi)(a - bi) = a^2 + b^2. \qquad (2)$$

The next step with complex numbers is $1/z$. How to divide by $a + ib$? The best idea is to multiply by $\bar{z}/\bar{z}$. That produces $z\bar{z}$ in the denominator, which is $a^2 + b^2$:

$$\frac{1}{a + ib} = \frac{1}{a + ib} \frac{a - ib}{a - ib} = \frac{a - ib}{a^2 + b^2} \qquad \frac{1}{3 + 2i} = \frac{1}{3 + 2i} \frac{3 - 2i}{3 - 2i} = \frac{3 - 2i}{13}.$$

In case $a^2 + b^2 = 1$, this says that $(a + ib)^{-1}$ is $a - ib$. **On the unit circle, $1/z$ equals $\bar{z}$.** Later we will say: $1/e^{i\theta}$ is $e^{-i\theta}$ (the conjugate). A better way to multiply and divide is to use the polar form with distance r and angle θ .

The Polar Form $re^{i\theta}$

The square root of $a^2 + b^2$ is $|z|$. This is the **absolute value** (or **modulus**) of the number $z = a + ib$. The square root $|z|$ is also written r , because it is the distance from 0 to z . **The real number r in the polar form gives the size of the complex number z :**

The absolute value of $z = a + ib$ is $|z| = \sqrt{a^2 + b^2}$. This is called r .

The absolute value of $z = 3 + 2i$ is $|z| = \sqrt{3^2 + 2^2}$. This is $r = \sqrt{13}$.

The other part of the polar form is the angle θ . The angle for $z = 5$ is $\theta = 0$ (because this z is real and positive). The angle for $z = 3i$ is $\pi/2$ radians. The angle for a negative $z = -9$ is π radians. **The angle doubles when the number is squared.** The polar form is excellent for multiplying complex numbers (not good for addition).

When the distance is r and the angle is θ , trigonometry gives the other two sides of the triangle. The real part (along the bottom) is $a = r \cos \theta$. The imaginary part (up or down) is $b = r \sin \theta$. Put those together, and the rectangular form becomes the polar form:

The number $z = a + ib$ is also $z = r \cos \theta + ir \sin \theta$. This is $re^{i\theta}$

Note: $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ has absolute value $r = 1$ because $\cos^2 \theta + \sin^2 \theta = 1$. Thus $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ lies on the circle of radius 1—the unit circle.

Example 1 Find r and θ for $z = 1 + i$ and also for the conjugate $\bar{z} = 1 - i$.

Solution The absolute value is the same for z and $\bar{z}$. For $z = 1 + i$ it is $r = \sqrt{1 + 1} = \sqrt{2}$:

$$|z|^2 = 1^2 + 1^2 = 2 \quad \text{and also} \quad |\bar{z}|^2 = 1^2 + (-1)^2 = 2.$$

The distance from the center is $\sqrt{2}$. What about the angle? The number $1 + i$ is at the point $(1, 1)$ in the complex plane. The angle to that point is $\pi/4$ radians or 45° . The cosine is $1/\sqrt{2}$ and the sine is $1/\sqrt{2}$. Combining r and θ brings back $z = 1 + i$:

$$r \cos \theta + ir \sin \theta = \sqrt{2} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right) + i \sqrt{2} \left(\frac{1}{\sqrt{2}} \right) = 1 + i.$$

The angle to the conjugate $1 - i$ can be positive or negative. We can go to $7\pi/4$ radians which is 315° . Or we can go *backwards through a negative angle*, to $-\pi/4$ radians or -45° . **If z is at angle θ , its conjugate $\bar{z}$ is at $2\pi - \theta$ and also at $-\theta$.**

We can freely add 2π or 4π or -2π to any angle! Those go full circles so the final point is the same. This explains why there are infinitely many choices of θ . Often we select the angle between zero and 2π radians. But $-\theta$ is very useful for the conjugate $\bar{z}$.

Powers and Products: Polar Form

Computing $(1 + i)^2$ and $(1 + i)^8$ is quickest in polar form. That form has $r = \sqrt{2}$ and $\theta = \pi/4$ (or 45°). If we square the absolute value to get $r^2 = 2$, and double the angle to get $2\theta = \pi/2$ (or 90°), we have $(1 + i)^2$. For the eighth power we need r^8 and 8θ :

$$(1 + i)^8 \quad r^8 = 2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 \cdot 2 = 16 \quad \text{and} \quad 8\theta = 8 \cdot \frac{\pi}{4} = 2\pi.$$

This means: $(1 + i)^8$ has absolute value 16 and angle 2π . *The eighth power of $1 + i$ is the real number 16.*

Powers are easy in polar form. So is multiplication of complex numbers.

The polar form of z^n has absolute value r^n . The angle is n times θ :

The n th power of $z = r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)$ is $z^n = r^n(\cos n\theta + i \sin n\theta)$. (3)

In that case z multiplies itself. In all cases, *multiply r 's and add the angles*:

$$r(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) \text{ times } r'(\cos \theta' + i \sin \theta') = rr'(\cos(\theta + \theta') + i \sin(\theta + \theta')). \quad (4)$$

One way to understand this is by trigonometry. Concentrate on angles. Why do we get the double angle 2θ for z^2 ?

$$(\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) \times (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta) = \cos^2 \theta + i^2 \sin^2 \theta + 2i \sin \theta \cos \theta.$$

The real part $\cos^2 \theta - \sin^2 \theta$ is $\cos 2\theta$. The imaginary part $2 \sin \theta \cos \theta$ is $\sin 2\theta$. Those are the “double angle” formulas. They show that θ in z becomes 2θ in z^2 .

There is a second way to understand the rule for z^n . It uses the only amazing formula in this section. Remember that $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ has absolute value 1. The cosine is made up of even powers, starting with $1 - \frac{1}{2}\theta^2$. The sine is made up of odd powers, starting with $\theta - \frac{1}{6}\theta^3$. The beautiful fact is that $e^{i\theta}$ combines both of those series into $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$:

$$e^x = 1 + x + \frac{1}{2}x^2 + \frac{1}{6}x^3 + \dots \quad \text{becomes} \quad e^{i\theta} = 1 + i\theta + \frac{1}{2}i^2\theta^2 + \frac{1}{6}i^3\theta^3 + \dots$$

Write -1 for i^2 to see $1 - \frac{1}{2}\theta^2$. **The complex number $e^{i\theta}$ is $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$:**

Euler's Formula $e^{i\theta} = \cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ gives $z = r \cos \theta + i r \sin \theta = r e^{i\theta}$ (5)

The special choice $\theta = 2\pi$ gives $\cos 2\pi + i \sin 2\pi$ which is 1. Somehow the infinite series $e^{2\pi i} = 1 + 2\pi i + \frac{1}{2}(2\pi i)^2 + \dots$ adds up to 1.

Now multiply $e^{i\theta}$ times $e^{i\theta'}$. Angles add for the same reason that exponents add:

$$e^2 \text{ times } e^3 \text{ is } e^5 \quad e^{i\theta} \text{ times } e^{i\theta} \text{ is } e^{2i\theta} \quad e^{i\theta} \text{ times } e^{i\theta'} \text{ is } e^{i(\theta+\theta')}$$

The powers $(r e^{i\theta})^n$ are equal to $r^n e^{in\theta}$. They stay on the unit circle when $r = 1$ and $r^n = 1$. Then we find n different numbers whose n th powers equal 1:

Set $w = e^{2\pi i/n}$. The n th powers of $1, w, w^2, \dots, w^{n-1}$ all equal 1.

Those are the “ n th roots of 1.” They solve the equation $z^n = 1$. They are equally spaced around the unit circle in Figure 10.2b, where the full 2π is divided by n . Multiply their angles by n to take n th powers. That gives $w^n = e^{2\pi i}$ which is 1. Also $(w^2)^n = e^{4\pi i} = 1$. Each of those numbers, to the n th power, comes around the unit circle to 1.

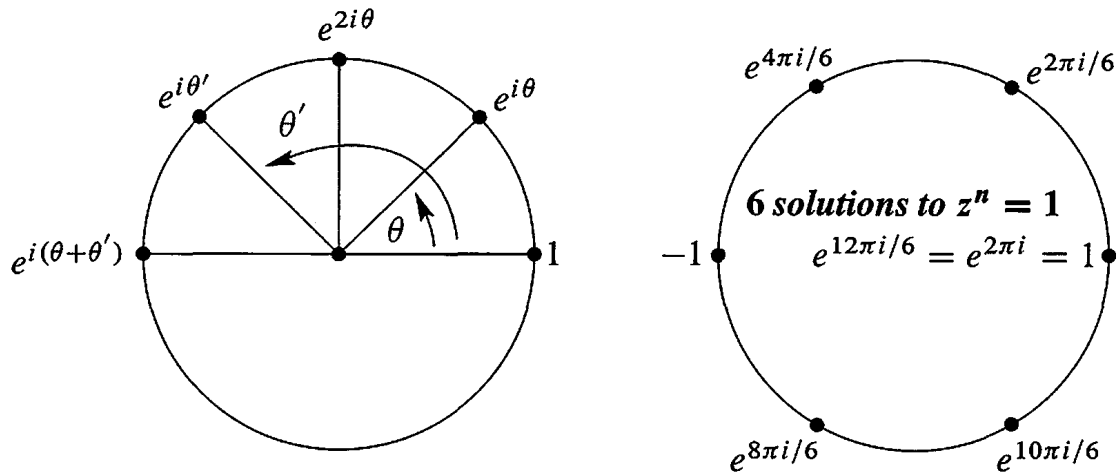


Figure 10.2: (a) Multiplying $e^{i\theta}$ times $e^{i\theta'}$. (b) The n th power of $e^{2\pi i/n}$ is $e^{2\pi i} = 1$.

These n roots of 1 are the key numbers for signal processing. The Discrete Fourier Transform uses w and its powers. Section 10.3 shows how to decompose a vector (a signal) into n frequencies by the Fast Fourier Transform.

■ REVIEW OF THE KEY IDEAS ■

1. Adding $a + ib$ to $c + id$ is like adding $(a, b) + (c, d)$. Use $i^2 = -1$ to multiply.
2. The conjugate of $z = a + bi = re^{i\theta}$ is $\bar{z} = z^* = a - bi = re^{-i\theta}$.
3. z times $\bar{z}$ is $re^{i\theta}$ times $re^{-i\theta}$. This is $r^2 = |z|^2 = a^2 + b^2$ (real).
4. Powers and products are easy in polar form $z = re^{i\theta}$. *Multiply r 's and add θ 's.*

Problem Set 10.1

Questions 1–8 are about operations on complex numbers.

1. Add and multiply each pair of complex numbers:
 - (a) $2 + i, 2 - i$
 - (b) $-1 + i, -1 + i$
 - (c) $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta, \cos \theta - i \sin \theta$
2. Locate these points on the complex plane. Simplify them if necessary:
 - (a) $2 + i$
 - (b) $(2 + i)^2$
 - (c) $\frac{1}{2+i}$
 - (d) $|2 + i|$
3. Find the absolute value $r = |z|$ of these four numbers. If θ is the angle for $6 - 8i$, what are the angles for the other three numbers?
 - (a) $6 - 8i$
 - (b) $(6 - 8i)^2$
 - (c) $\frac{1}{6-8i}$
 - (d) $(6 + 8i)^2$

- 4 If $|z| = 2$ and $|w| = 3$ then $|z \times w| = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and $|z + w| \leq \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and $|z/w| = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and $|z - w| \leq \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.
- 5 Find $a + ib$ for the numbers at angles $30^\circ, 60^\circ, 90^\circ, 120^\circ$ on the unit circle. If w is the number at 30° , check that w^2 is at 60° . What power of w equals 1?
- 6 If $z = r \cos \theta + ir \sin \theta$ then $1/z$ has absolute value $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$ and angle $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. Its polar form is $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. Multiply $z \times 1/z$ to get 1.
- 7 The complex multiplication $M = (a + bi)(c + di)$ is a 2 by 2 real multiplication

$$\begin{bmatrix} a & -b \\ b & a \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} c \\ d \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} \\ \end{bmatrix}.$$

The right side contains the real and imaginary parts of M . Test $M = (1 + 3i)(1 - 3i)$.

- 8 $A = A_1 + iA_2$ is a complex n by n matrix and $b = b_1 + ib_2$ is a complex vector. The solution to $Ax = b$ is $x_1 + ix_2$. Write $Ax = b$ as a real system of size $2n$:

$$\begin{array}{l} \text{Complex } n \text{ by } n \\ \text{Real } 2n \text{ by } 2n \end{array} \quad \begin{bmatrix} \\ \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x_1 \\ x_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} b_1 \\ b_2 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Questions 9–16 are about the conjugate $\bar{z} = a - ib = re^{-i\theta} = z^*$.

- 9 Write down the complex conjugate of each number by changing i to $-i$:
- (a) $2 - i$ (b) $(2 - i)(1 - i)$ (c) $e^{i\pi/2}$ (which is i)
 (d) $e^{i\pi} = -1$ (e) $\frac{1+i}{1-i}$ (which is also i) (f) $i^{103} = \underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.
- 10 The sum $z + \bar{z}$ is always $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. The difference $z - \bar{z}$ is always $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. Assume $z \neq 0$. The product $z \times \bar{z}$ is always $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$. The ratio $z/\bar{z}$ always has absolute value $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.
- 11 For a real matrix, the conjugate of $Ax = \lambda x$ is $A\bar{x} = \bar{\lambda}\bar{x}$. This proves two things: $\bar{\lambda}$ is another eigenvalue and $\bar{x}$ is its eigenvector. Find the eigenvalues $\lambda, \bar{\lambda}$ and eigenvectors $x, \bar{x}$ of $A = \begin{bmatrix} a & b \\ -b & a \end{bmatrix}$.
- 12 The eigenvalues of a real 2 by 2 matrix come from the quadratic formula:

$$\det \begin{bmatrix} a - \lambda & b \\ c & d - \lambda \end{bmatrix} = \lambda^2 - (a + d)\lambda + (ad - bc) = 0$$

gives the two eigenvalues $\lambda = \left[a + d \pm \sqrt{(a + d)^2 - 4(ad - bc)} \right] / 2$.

- (a) If $a = b = d = 1$, the eigenvalues are complex when c is $\underline{\hspace{2cm}}$.
- (b) What are the eigenvalues when $ad = bc$?
- (c) The two eigenvalues (plus sign and minus sign) are not always conjugates of each other. Why not?

- 13 In Problem 12 the eigenvalues are not real when $(\text{trace})^2 = (a + d)^2$ is smaller than _____. Show that the λ 's are real when $bc > 0$.
- 14 Find the eigenvalues and eigenvectors of this permutation matrix:

$$P_4 = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 0 \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{has} \quad \det(P_4 - \lambda I) = \text{_____}.$$

- 15 Extend P_4 above to P_6 (five 1's below the diagonal and one in the corner). Find $\det(P_6 - \lambda I)$ and the six eigenvalues in the complex plane.
- 16 A real skew-symmetric matrix ($A^T = -A$) has pure imaginary eigenvalues. First proof: If $Ax = \lambda x$ then block multiplication gives

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & A \\ -A & 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x \\ ix \end{bmatrix} = i\lambda \begin{bmatrix} x \\ ix \end{bmatrix}.$$

This block matrix is symmetric. Its eigenvalues must be _____! So λ is _____.

Questions 17–24 are about the form $re^{i\theta}$ of the complex number $r \cos \theta + ir \sin \theta$.

- 17 Write these numbers in Euler's form $re^{i\theta}$. Then square each number:
 (a) $1 + \sqrt{3}i$ (b) $\cos 2\theta + i \sin 2\theta$ (c) $-7i$ (d) $5 - 5i$.
- 18 Find the absolute value and the angle for $z = \sin \theta + i \cos \theta$ (careful). Locate this z in the complex plane. Multiply z by $\cos \theta + i \sin \theta$ to get _____.
- 19 Draw all eight solutions of $z^8 = 1$ in the complex plane. What is the rectangular form $a + ib$ of the root $z = \bar{w} = \exp(-2\pi i/8)$?
- 20 Locate the cube roots of 1 in the complex plane. Locate the cube roots of -1 . Together these are the sixth roots of _____.
- 21 By comparing $e^{3i\theta} = \cos 3\theta + i \sin 3\theta$ with $(e^{i\theta})^3 = (\cos \theta + i \sin \theta)^3$, find the "triple angle" formulas for $\cos 3\theta$ and $\sin 3\theta$ in terms of $\cos \theta$ and $\sin \theta$.
- 22 Suppose the conjugate $\bar{z}$ is equal to the reciprocal $1/z$. What are all possible z 's?
- 23 (a) Why do e^i and i^e both have absolute value 1?
 (b) In the complex plane put stars near the points e^i and i^e .
 (c) The number i^e could be $(e^{i\pi/2})^e$ or $(e^{5i\pi/2})^e$. Are those equal?
- 24 Draw the paths of these numbers from $t = 0$ to $t = 2\pi$ in the complex plane:
 (a) e^{it} (b) $e^{(-1+i)t} = e^{-t}e^{it}$ (c) $(-1)^t = e^{t\pi i}$.

10.2 Hermitian and Unitary Matrices

The main message of this section can be presented in one sentence: ***When you transpose a complex vector z or matrix A , take the complex conjugate too.*** Don't stop at z^T or A^T . Reverse the signs of all imaginary parts. From a column vector with $z_j = a_j + ib_j$, the good row vector is the *conjugate transpose* with components $a_j - ib_j$:

$$\text{Conjugate transpose} \quad \bar{z}^T = [\bar{z}_1 \ \cdots \ \bar{z}_n] = [a_1 - ib_1 \ \cdots \ a_n - ib_n]. \quad (1)$$

Here is one reason to go to $\bar{z}$. The length squared of a real vector is $x_1^2 + \cdots + x_n^2$. The length squared of a complex vector is *not* $z_1^2 + \cdots + z_n^2$. With that wrong definition, the length of $(1, i)$ would be $1^2 + i^2 = 0$. A nonzero vector would have zero length—not good. Other vectors would have complex lengths. Instead of $(a + bi)^2$ we want $a^2 + b^2$, the *absolute value squared*. This is $(a + bi)$ times $(a - bi)$.

For each component we want z_j times $\bar{z}_j$, which is $|z_j|^2 = a_j^2 + b_j^2$. That comes when the components of z multiply the components of $\bar{z}$:

$$\text{Length squared} \quad [\bar{z}_1 \ \cdots \ \bar{z}_n] \begin{bmatrix} z_1 \\ \vdots \\ z_n \end{bmatrix} = |z_1|^2 + \cdots + |z_n|^2. \quad \text{This is} \quad \bar{z}^T z = \|z\|^2. \quad (2)$$

Now the squared length of $(1, i)$ is $1^2 + |i|^2 = 2$. The length is $\sqrt{2}$. The squared length of $(1 + i, 1 - i)$ is 4. The only vectors with zero length are zero vectors.

The length $\|z\|$ is the square root of $\bar{z}^T z = z^H z = |z_1|^2 + \cdots + |z_n|^2$

Before going further we replace two symbols by one symbol. Instead of a bar for the conjugate and T for the transpose, we just use a superscript H. Thus $\bar{z}^T = z^H$. This is “z Hermitian,” the *conjugate transpose* of z . The new word is pronounced “Hermeeshan.” The new symbol applies also to matrices: The conjugate transpose of a matrix A is A^H .

Another popular notation is A^* . The MATLAB transpose command $'$ automatically takes complex conjugates (A' is A^H).

The vector z^H is $\bar{z}^T$. The matrix A^H is $\bar{A}^T$, the conjugate transpose of A :

$$A^H = \text{“A Hermitian”} \quad \text{If} \quad A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & i \\ 0 & 1 + i \end{bmatrix} \quad \text{then} \quad A^H = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 \\ -i & 1 - i \end{bmatrix}$$

Complex Inner Products

For real vectors, the length squared is $x^T x$ —the *inner product of x with itself*. For complex vectors, the length squared is $z^H z$. It will be very desirable if $z^H z$ is the inner product of z with itself. To make that happen, the complex inner product should use the conjugate transpose (not just the transpose). The inner product sees no change when the vectors are real, but there is a definite effect from choosing $\bar{u}^T$, when u is complex:

DEFINITION The inner product of real or complex vectors u and v is $u^H v$:

$$u^H v = [\bar{u}_1 \ \cdots \ \bar{u}_n] \begin{bmatrix} v_1 \\ \vdots \\ v_n \end{bmatrix} = \bar{u}_1 v_1 + \cdots + \bar{u}_n v_n. \quad (3)$$

With complex vectors, $u^H v$ is different from $v^H u$. The order of the vectors is now important. In fact $v^H u = \bar{v}_1 u_1 + \cdots + \bar{v}_n u_n$ is the complex conjugate of $u^H v$. We have to put up with a few inconveniences for the greater good.

Example 1 The inner product of $u = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ i \end{bmatrix}$ with $v = \begin{bmatrix} i \\ 1 \end{bmatrix}$ is $[1 \ -i] \begin{bmatrix} i \\ 1 \end{bmatrix} = 0$.

Example 1 is surprising. Those vectors $(1, i)$ and $(i, 1)$ don't look perpendicular. But they are. **A zero inner product still means that the (complex) vectors are orthogonal.** Similarly the vector $(1, i)$ is orthogonal to the vector $(1, -i)$. Their inner product is $1 - 1 = 0$. We are correctly getting zero for the inner product—where we would be incorrectly getting zero for the length of $(1, i)$ if we forgot to take the conjugate.

Note We have chosen to conjugate the first vector u . Some authors choose the second vector v . Their complex inner product would be $u^T \bar{v}$. It is a free choice, as long as we stick to it. We wanted to use the single symbol H in the next formula too:

The inner product of Au with v equals the inner product of u with $A^H v$:

$$A^H = \text{"adjoint" of } A \quad (Au)^H v = u^H (A^H v). \quad (4)$$

The conjugate of Au is $\overline{Au}$. Transposing it gives $\bar{u}^T \bar{A}^T$ as usual. This is $u^H A^H$. Everything that should work, does work. The rule for H comes from the rule for T . That applies to products of matrices:

The conjugate transpose of AB is $(AB)^H = B^H A^H$.

We constantly use the fact that $(a - ib)(c - id)$ is the conjugate of $(a + ib)(c + id)$.

Hermitian Matrices

Among real matrices, the *symmetric matrices* form the most important special class: $A = A^T$. They have real eigenvalues and a full set of orthogonal eigenvectors. The diagonalizing matrix S is an orthogonal matrix Q . Every symmetric matrix can be written as $A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1}$ and also as $A = Q\Lambda Q^T$ (because $Q^{-1} = Q^T$). All this follows from $a_{ij} = a_{ji}$, when A is real.

Among complex matrices, the special class contains the **Hermitian matrices**: $A = A^H$. The condition on the entries is $a_{ij} = \overline{a_{ji}}$. In this case we say that “ A is Hermitian.” Every real symmetric matrix is Hermitian, because taking its conjugate has no effect. The next matrix is also Hermitian, $A = A^H$:

Example 2 $A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3-3i \\ 3+3i & 5 \end{bmatrix}$ The main diagonal is real since $a_{ii} = \overline{a_{ii}}$.
Across it are conjugates $3+3i$ and $3-3i$.

This example will illustrate the three crucial properties of all Hermitian matrices.

If $A = A^H$ and z is any vector, the number $z^H A z$ is real.

Quick proof: $z^H A z$ is certainly 1 by 1. Take its conjugate transpose:

$$(z^H A z)^H = z^H A^H (z^H)^H \quad \text{which is } z^H A z \text{ again.}$$

This used $A = A^H$. So the number $z^H A z$ equals its conjugate and must be real. Here is that “energy” $z^H A z$ in our example:

$$\begin{bmatrix} \bar{z}_1 & \bar{z}_2 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 3-3i \\ 3+3i & 5 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} z_1 \\ z_2 \end{bmatrix} = \underbrace{2\bar{z}_1 z_1 + 5\bar{z}_2 z_2}_{\text{diagonal}} + \underbrace{(3-3i)\bar{z}_1 z_2 + (3+3i)z_1 \bar{z}_2}_{\text{off-diagonal}}.$$

The terms $2|z_1|^2$ and $5|z_2|^2$ from the diagonal are both real. The off-diagonal terms are conjugates of each other—so their sum is real. (The imaginary parts cancel when we add.) The whole expression $z^H A z$ is real, and this will make λ real.

Every eigenvalue of a Hermitian matrix is real.

Proof Suppose $Az = \lambda z$. Multiply both sides by z^H to get $z^H A z = \lambda z^H z$. On the left side, $z^H A z$ is real. On the right side, $z^H z$ is the length squared, real and positive. So the ratio $\lambda = z^H A z / z^H z$ is a real number. Q.E.D.

The example above has eigenvalues $\lambda = 8$ and $\lambda = -1$, real because $A = A^H$:

$$\begin{vmatrix} 2-\lambda & 3-3i \\ 3+3i & 5-\lambda \end{vmatrix} = \lambda^2 - 7\lambda + 10 - |3+3i|^2 \\ = \lambda^2 - 7\lambda + 10 - 18 = (\lambda - 8)(\lambda + 1).$$

The eigenvectors of a Hermitian matrix are orthogonal (when they correspond to different eigenvalues). If $Az = \lambda z$ and $Ay = \beta y$ then $y^H z = 0$.

Proof Multiply $Az = \lambda z$ on the left by y^H . Multiply $y^H A^H = \beta y^H$ on the right by z :

$$y^H A z = \lambda y^H z \quad \text{and} \quad y^H A^H z = \beta y^H z. \quad (5)$$

The left sides are equal because $A = A^H$. Therefore the right sides are equal. Since β is different from λ , the other factor $y^H z$ must be zero. The eigenvectors are orthogonal, as in our example with $\lambda = 8$ and $\beta = -1$:

$$\begin{aligned} (A - 8I)z &= \begin{bmatrix} -6 & 3 - 3i \\ 3 + 3i & -3 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} z_1 \\ z_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} & \text{and} & z = \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 + i \end{bmatrix} \\ (A + I)y &= \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 3 - 3i \\ 3 + 3i & 6 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} y_1 \\ y_2 \end{bmatrix} = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} & \text{and} & y = \begin{bmatrix} 1 - i \\ -1 \end{bmatrix}. \end{aligned}$$

Take the inner product of those eigenvectors y and z :

Orthogonal eigenvectors $y^H z = \begin{bmatrix} 1 + i & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 1 + i \end{bmatrix} = 0.$

These eigenvectors have squared length $1^2 + 1^2 + 1^2 = 3$. After division by $\sqrt{3}$ they are unit vectors. They were orthogonal, now they are *orthonormal*. They go into the columns of the *eigenvector matrix* S , which diagonalizes A .

When A is real and symmetric, S is Q —an orthogonal matrix. Now A is complex and Hermitian. Its eigenvectors are complex and orthonormal. *The eigenvector matrix S is like Q , but complex.* We now assign a new name “unitary” and a new letter U to a complex orthogonal matrix.

Unitary Matrices

A *unitary matrix* U is a (complex) square matrix that has *orthonormal columns*. U is the complex equivalent of Q . The eigenvectors of A give a perfect example:

Unitary matrix
$$U = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 - i \\ 1 + i & -1 \end{bmatrix}$$

This U is also a Hermitian matrix. I didn't expect that! The example is almost too perfect. We will see that the eigenvalues of this U must be 1 and -1 .

The matrix test for real orthonormal columns was $Q^T Q = I$. When Q^T multiplies Q , the zero inner products appear off the diagonal. In the complex case, Q becomes U . The columns show themselves as orthonormal when U^H multiplies U . The inner products of the columns are again 1 and 0. They fill up $U^H U = I$:

Every matrix U with orthonormal columns has $U^H U = I$.

If U is square, it is a unitary matrix. Then $U^H = U^{-1}$.

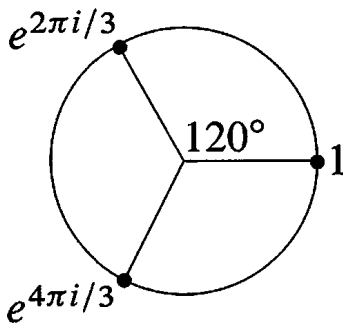
Suppose U (with orthonormal columns) multiplies any z . The vector length stays the same, because $z^H U^H U z = z^H z$. If z is an eigenvector of U we learn something more: *The eigenvalues of unitary (and orthogonal) matrices all have absolute value $|\lambda| = 1$.*

If U is unitary then $\|Uz\| = \|z\|$. Therefore $Uz = \lambda z$ leads to $|\lambda| = 1$.

Our 2 by 2 example is both Hermitian ($U = U^H$) and unitary ($U^{-1} = U^H$). That means real eigenvalues ($\lambda = \bar{\lambda}$), and it means $|\lambda| = 1$. A real number with absolute value 1 has only two possibilities: *The eigenvalues are 1 or -1 .*

Since the trace is zero for our U , one eigenvalue is $\lambda = 1$ and the other is $\lambda = -1$.

Example 3 The 3 by 3 *Fourier matrix* is in Figure 10.3. Is it Hermitian? Is it unitary? F_3 is certainly symmetric. It equals its transpose. But it doesn't equal its conjugate transpose—it is *not Hermitian*. If you change i to $-i$, you get a different matrix.



Fourier matrix
$$F = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & e^{2\pi i/3} & e^{4\pi i/3} \\ 1 & e^{4\pi i/3} & e^{2\pi i/3} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Figure 10.3: The cube roots of 1 go into the Fourier matrix $F = F_3$.

Is F unitary? *Yes*. The squared length of every column is $\frac{1}{3}(1 + 1 + 1)$ (unit vector). The first column is orthogonal to the second column because $1 + e^{2\pi i/3} + e^{4\pi i/3} = 0$. This is the sum of the three numbers marked in Figure 10.3.

Notice the symmetry of the figure. If you rotate it by 120° , the three points are in the same position. Therefore their sum S also stays in the same position! The only possible sum in the same position after 120° rotation is $S = 0$.

Is column 2 of F orthogonal to column 3? Their dot product looks like

$$\frac{1}{3}(1 + e^{6\pi i/3} + e^{6\pi i/3}) = \frac{1}{3}(1 + 1 + 1).$$

This is not zero. The answer is wrong because we forgot to take complex conjugates. The complex inner product uses H not T :

$$\begin{aligned} (\text{column 2})^H(\text{column 3}) &= \frac{1}{3}(1 \cdot 1 + e^{-2\pi i/3} e^{4\pi i/3} + e^{-4\pi i/3} e^{2\pi i/3}) \\ &= \frac{1}{3}(1 + e^{2\pi i/3} + e^{-2\pi i/3}) = 0. \end{aligned}$$

So we do have orthogonality. **Conclusion: F is a unitary matrix.**

The next section will study the n by n Fourier matrices. Among all complex unitary matrices, these are the most important. When we multiply a vector by F , we are computing its *Discrete Fourier Transform*. When we multiply by F^{-1} , we are computing the *inverse transform*. The special property of unitary matrices is that $F^{-1} = F^H$. The inverse

transform only differs by changing i to $-i$:

Change i to $-i$
$$F^{-1} = F^H = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & e^{-2\pi i/3} & e^{-4\pi i/3} \\ 1 & e^{-4\pi i/3} & e^{-2\pi i/3} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Everyone who works with F recognizes its value. The last section of the book will bring together Fourier analysis and complex numbers and linear algebra.

This section ends with a table to translate between real and complex—for vectors and for matrices:

Real versus Complex

$\mathbf{R}^n$: vectors with n real components	$\leftrightarrow$	$\mathbf{C}^n$: vectors with n complex components
length: $\ \mathbf{x}\ ^2 = x_1^2 + \cdots + x_n^2$	$\leftrightarrow$	length: $\ \mathbf{z}\ ^2 = z_1 ^2 + \cdots + z_n ^2$
transpose: $(A^T)_{ij} = A_{ji}$	$\leftrightarrow$	conjugate transpose: $(A^H)_{ij} = \overline{A_{ji}}$
product rule: $(AB)^T = B^T A^T$	$\leftrightarrow$	product rule: $(AB)^H = B^H A^H$
dot product: $\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{y} = x_1 y_1 + \cdots + x_n y_n$	$\leftrightarrow$	inner product: $\mathbf{u}^H \mathbf{v} = \overline{u_1} v_1 + \cdots + \overline{u_n} v_n$
reason for A^T : $(A\mathbf{x})^T \mathbf{y} = \mathbf{x}^T (A^T \mathbf{y})$	$\leftrightarrow$	reason for A^H : $(A\mathbf{u})^H \mathbf{v} = \mathbf{u}^H (A^H \mathbf{v})$
orthogonality: $\mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{y} = 0$	$\leftrightarrow$	orthogonality: $\mathbf{u}^H \mathbf{v} = 0$
symmetric matrices: $A = A^T$	$\leftrightarrow$	Hermitian matrices: $A = A^H$
$A = Q\Lambda Q^{-1} = Q\Lambda Q^T$ (real Λ)	$\leftrightarrow$	$A = U\Lambda U^{-1} = U\Lambda U^H$ (real Λ)
skew-symmetric matrices: $K^T = -K$	$\leftrightarrow$	skew-Hermitian matrices: $K^H = -K$
orthogonal matrices: $Q^T = Q^{-1}$	$\leftrightarrow$	unitary matrices: $U^H = U^{-1}$
orthonormal columns: $Q^T Q = I$	$\leftrightarrow$	orthonormal columns: $U^H U = I$
$(Q\mathbf{x})^T (Q\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{x}^T \mathbf{y}$ and $\ Q\mathbf{x}\ = \ \mathbf{x}\ $	$\leftrightarrow$	$(U\mathbf{x})^H (U\mathbf{y}) = \mathbf{x}^H \mathbf{y}$ and $\ U\mathbf{z}\ = \ \mathbf{z}\ $

The columns and also the eigenvectors of Q and U are orthonormal. Every $|\lambda| = 1$.

Problem Set 10.2

- Find the lengths of $\mathbf{u} = (1 + i, 1 - i, 1 + 2i)$ and $\mathbf{v} = (i, i, i)$. Also find $\mathbf{u}^H \mathbf{v}$ and $\mathbf{v}^H \mathbf{u}$.
- Compute $A^H A$ and $A A^H$. Those are both _____ matrices:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} i & 1 & i \\ 1 & i & i \end{bmatrix}.$$

- Solve $A\mathbf{z} = \mathbf{0}$ to find a vector in the nullspace of A in Problem 2. Show that $\mathbf{z}$ is orthogonal to the columns of A^H . Show that $\mathbf{z}$ is *not* orthogonal to the columns of A^T . *The good row space is no longer $C(A^T)$.* Now it is $C(A^H)$.

- 4 Problem 3 indicates that the four fundamental subspaces are $C(A)$ and $N(A)$ and _____ and _____. Their dimensions are still r and $n - r$ and r and $m - r$. They are still orthogonal subspaces. *The symbol H takes the place of T .*
- 5 (a) Prove that $A^H A$ is always a Hermitian matrix.
 (b) If $Az = \mathbf{0}$ then $A^H Az = \mathbf{0}$. If $A^H Az = \mathbf{0}$, multiply by z^H to prove that $Az = \mathbf{0}$. The nullspaces of A and $A^H A$ are _____. Therefore $A^H A$ is an invertible Hermitian matrix when the nullspace of A contains only $z = \mathbf{0}$.
- 6 True or false (give a reason if true or a counterexample if false):
 (a) If A is a real matrix then $A + iI$ is invertible.
 (b) If A is a Hermitian matrix then $A + iI$ is invertible.
 (c) If U is a unitary matrix then $A + iI$ is invertible.
- 7 When you multiply a Hermitian matrix by a real number c , is cA still Hermitian? Show that iA is skew-Hermitian when A is Hermitian. The 3 by 3 Hermitian matrices are a subspace provided the “scalars” are real numbers.
- 8 Which classes of matrices does P belong to: invertible, Hermitian, unitary?

$$P = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & i & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & i \\ i & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}.$$

Compute P^2 , P^3 , and P^{100} . What are the eigenvalues of P ?

- 9 Find the unit eigenvectors of P in Problem 8, and put them into the columns of a unitary matrix F . What property of P makes these eigenvectors orthogonal?
- 10 Write down the 3 by 3 circulant matrix $C = 2I + 5P$. It has the same eigenvectors as P in Problem 8. Find its eigenvalues.
- 11 If U and V are unitary matrices, show that U^{-1} is unitary and also UV is unitary. Start from $U^H U = I$ and $V^H V = I$.
- 12 How do you know that the determinant of every Hermitian matrix is real?
- 13 The matrix $A^H A$ is not only Hermitian but also positive definite, when the columns of A are independent. Proof: $z^H A^H A z$ is positive if z is nonzero because _____.
- 14 Diagonalize this Hermitian matrix to reach $A = U \Lambda U^H$:

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & 1 - i \\ i + 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 15 Diagonalize this skew-Hermitian matrix to reach $K = U\Lambda U^H$. All λ 's are _____:

$$K = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -1+i \\ 1+i & i \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 16 Diagonalize this orthogonal matrix to reach $Q = U\Lambda U^H$. Now all λ 's are _____:

$$Q = \begin{bmatrix} \cos \theta & -\sin \theta \\ \sin \theta & \cos \theta \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 17 Diagonalize this unitary matrix V to reach $V = U\Lambda U^H$. Again all λ 's are _____:

$$V = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 1-i \\ 1+i & -1 \end{bmatrix}.$$

- 18 If $v_1, \dots, v_n$ is an orthonormal basis for $\mathbb{C}^n$, the matrix with those columns is a _____ matrix. Show that any vector z equals $(v_1^H z)v_1 + \dots + (v_n^H z)v_n$.

- 19 The functions e^{-ix} and e^{ix} are orthogonal on the interval $0 \leq x \leq 2\pi$ because their inner product is $\int_0^{2\pi}$ _____ $= 0$.

- 20 The vectors $v = (1, i, 1)$, $w = (i, 1, 0)$ and $z =$ _____ are an orthogonal basis for _____.

- 21 If $A = R + iS$ is a Hermitian matrix, are its real and imaginary parts symmetric?

- 22 The (complex) dimension of $\mathbb{C}^n$ is _____. Find a non-real basis for $\mathbb{C}^n$.

- 23 Describe all 1 by 1 and 2 by 2 Hermitian matrices and unitary matrices.

- 24 How are the eigenvalues of A^H related to the eigenvalues of the square complex matrix A ?

- 25 If $u^H u = 1$ show that $I - 2uu^H$ is Hermitian and also unitary. The rank-one matrix uu^H is the projection onto what line in $\mathbb{C}^n$?

- 26 If $A + iB$ is a unitary matrix (A and B are real) show that $Q = \begin{bmatrix} A & -B \\ B & A \end{bmatrix}$ is an orthogonal matrix.

- 27 If $A + iB$ is Hermitian (A and B are real) show that $\begin{bmatrix} A & -B \\ B & A \end{bmatrix}$ is symmetric.

- 28 Prove that the inverse of a Hermitian matrix is also Hermitian (transpose $A^{-1} A = I$).

- 29 Diagonalize this matrix by constructing its eigenvalue matrix Λ and its eigenvector matrix S :

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1-i \\ 1+i & 3 \end{bmatrix} = A^H.$$

- 30 A matrix with orthonormal eigenvectors has the form $A = U\Lambda U^{-1} = U\Lambda U^H$. Prove that $AA^H = A^H A$. These are exactly the **normal matrices**. Examples are Hermitian, skew-Hermitian, and unitary matrices. Construct a 2 by 2 normal matrix by choosing complex eigenvalues in Λ .

10.3 The Fast Fourier Transform

Many applications of linear algebra take time to develop. It is not easy to explain them in an hour. The teacher and the author must choose between completing the theory and adding new applications. Often the theory wins, but this section is an exception. It explains the most valuable numerical algorithm in the last century.

We want to multiply quickly by F and F^{-1} , the Fourier matrix and its inverse. This is achieved by the Fast Fourier Transform. An ordinary product Fc uses n^2 multiplications (F has n^2 entries). The FFT needs only n times $\frac{1}{2} \log_2 n$. We will see how.

The FFT has revolutionized signal processing. Whole industries are speeded up by this one idea. Electrical engineers are the first to know the difference—they take your Fourier transform as they meet you (if you are a function). Fourier's idea is to represent f as a sum of harmonics $c_k e^{ikx}$. The function is seen in *frequency space* through the coefficients c_k , instead of *physical space* through its values $f(x)$. The passage backward and forward between c 's and f 's is by the Fourier transform. Fast passage is by the FFT.

Roots of Unity and the Fourier Matrix

Quadratic equations have two roots (or one repeated root). Equations of degree n have n roots (counting repetitions). This is the Fundamental Theorem of Algebra, and to make it true we must allow complex roots. This section is about the very special equation $z^n = 1$. The solutions z are the " n th roots of unity." They are n evenly spaced points around the unit circle in the complex plane.

Figure 10.4 shows the eight solutions to $z^8 = 1$. Their spacing is $\frac{1}{8}(360^\circ) = 45^\circ$. The first root is at 45° or $\theta = 2\pi/8$ radians. *It is the complex number $w = e^{i\theta} = e^{i2\pi/8}$.* We call this number w_8 to emphasize that it is an 8th root. You could write it in terms of $\cos \frac{2\pi}{8}$ and $\sin \frac{2\pi}{8}$, but don't do it. The seven other 8th roots are $w^2, w^3, \dots, w^7$, going around the circle. Powers of w are best in polar form, because we work only with the angles $\frac{2\pi}{8}, \frac{4\pi}{8}, \dots, \frac{16\pi}{8} = 2\pi$.

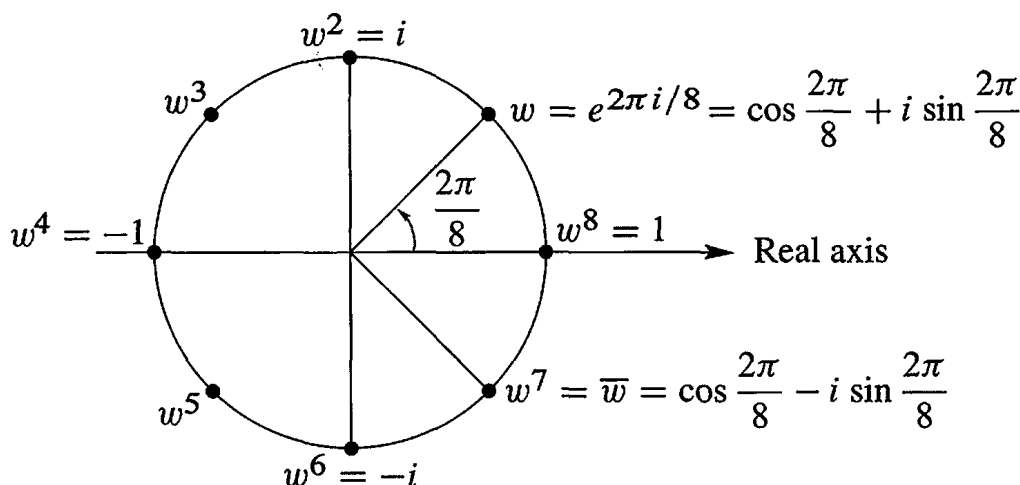


Figure 10.4: The eight solutions to $z^8 = 1$ are $1, w, w^2, \dots, w^7$ with $w = (1 + i)/\sqrt{2}$.